OptionIQ

Understand Risk. Protect Capital.

User Manual & Training Guide

Every tab, every button, step by step

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QUANTUM NEXUS LLC

Building Intelligent Solutions for a Smarter Future

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How to use this manual

This manual is both a reference and a training course. It explains every screen, every button and every box in OptionIQ, in plain language, with a picture of each one.

- **New to OptionIQ?** Read Part 1 first. It takes you from the zip file to your first trade. Then try the practice exercises in Chapter 19.
- **Looking for one button?** Use the **Contents** on the next pages, or the **Index** at the back. The index lists words in A to Z order with the page where each one is explained.
- **Orange numbered circles** in the pictures match the numbered rows in the table under each picture.

All the pictures use **made-up practice trades** in three made-up accounts called Roth IRA, Brokerage and Spouse IRA. The tickers are real companies, but the prices, trades and amounts are not real.

What you see in this manual	What it means
Bold words	A button, tab or box exactly as it appears on screen.
⚙️ Settings → About	Click ⚙️ Settings, then go to the About part.
Tip boxes	A shortcut or good habit.
Careful boxes	Something that changes or replaces your information.

OptionIQ is a record-keeping and research tool. It never places trades and it is not financial advice. Always check prices and details with your broker before you trade.

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Part 1. Getting started

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1. Welcome to OptionIQ

OptionIQ keeps a log of the options you sell or buy and the stocks you own, in each of your brokerage accounts. It works out your profit and loss, warns you before options expire, and helps you find and judge new trades.

Everything stays on your own computer, in one folder. Nothing is sent anywhere except ticker symbols when the app looks up prices, and a regular check for a new version of the app.

What OptionIQ can do for you

Area	What it does	Chapter
📋 Options	Logs every option trade, open and closed, with live profit and loss	6
🏦 Stocks	Tracks the shares you own, including shares you got from an assigned put	7
📈 Analytics	Charts of your profit by ticker, month and week, and the money set aside for puts	8
🏅 Scorecard	Honest results: return on the money at risk, rolls, strategies, sectors, and a comparison with the index	9
🎯 Screener	Finds new put and covered-call trades and suggests rolls for trades you hold	10
🔬 Analysis	A buy / hold / trim view of every stock you own or watch	11
🔭 Discover	Scans the whole S&P 500 for new names worth watching	12
👁️ Watchlist	A health card for each stock you hold or trade	13
📅 Calendar	Each open option on the day it expires	14
🔔 Reminders	Expiring options, options past expiry, and backups that are due	16

A few words you will see often (the Glossary in Chapter 21 has more)

Word	Meaning
Put	An option that lets the buyer sell 100 shares to you at the strike price. When you **sell** a put you are paid a premium and promise to buy the shares if the price falls below the strike.
Call	An option that lets the buyer buy 100 shares from you at the strike price. A **covered call** is a call you sell on shares you already own.
Premium	The money paid for an option, per share. One contract covers 100 shares, so a $1.20 premium is $120 per contract.
Strike	The price at which the shares would change hands.
Expiry	The last day of the option.
Net P&L	Profit and loss after the small fee the app subtracts for each contract.

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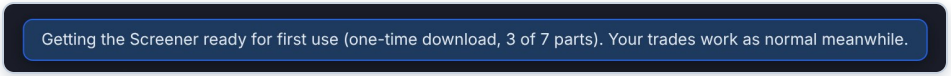
2. Installing OptionIQ

On Windows

You need the file **OptionIQ.zip** and a Windows 10 or 11 computer. Nothing else has to be installed.

1. **Make a new, empty folder** for the app. For example, right-click your Desktop, choose **New → Folder**, and name it `OptionIQ`.
2. **Move the zip file into that folder.**
3. **Right-click the zip file** and choose **Extract All...**.
4. Windows suggests a new folder with the zip's name. **Delete that last part** so the box shows only your new folder, then click **Extract**. (If you leave it, everything ends up one folder deeper. That still works.)
5. Open the folder. You should see **Start OptionIQ**, **READ ME FIRST**, **README** and a folder called **app**.
6. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.** If a blue box says **"Windows protected your PC"**, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Windows asks this only once.
7. The app opens in its own window after a few seconds. To close it, close the window.

The first time only, the app downloads the parts the Screener needs (about 30 MB, usually a minute or two). A blue message at the bottom shows how far along it is. Your trades work as normal meanwhile.



The one-time download message at the bottom of the screen on first start

If the message turns red, the download didn't work. Check your internet and click **Try again**.

Desktop icon. The first time OptionIQ starts, it puts an **OptionIQ** icon on your desktop. Double-click it to start the app each day. If you delete it, ⚙️ Settings → About has a button to put it back.

On a Mac

On a Mac you need **OptionIQ for Mac.zip** and macOS 11 (Big Sur) or newer. It works on Apple-chip and Intel Macs. Everything after this section is the same on a Mac.

1. Put the zip file where you want the app to live, for example in **Documents**.
2. **Double-click the zip file.** The Mac unzips it into a new folder called **OptionIQ**. Open it.
3. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.command.** The first time, the Mac says it can't check the file. Click **Done**, open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to **"Start OptionIQ.command" was blocked**, click **Open Anyway**, enter your Mac password if asked,

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and click **Open Anyway** again. On macOS 14 or earlier you can instead right-click the file, choose **Open**, then **Open**. You do this only once.

4. A **Terminal** window opens. The first time only, it downloads the app's own copy of Python (about 20 MB). When it says OptionIQ is starting, you can close the Terminal window.
5. The app opens in its own window if Chrome, Edge or Brave is installed; otherwise it opens in Safari.
6. To close it, press **⌘ Command + Q** in its window, or close its Safari tab.

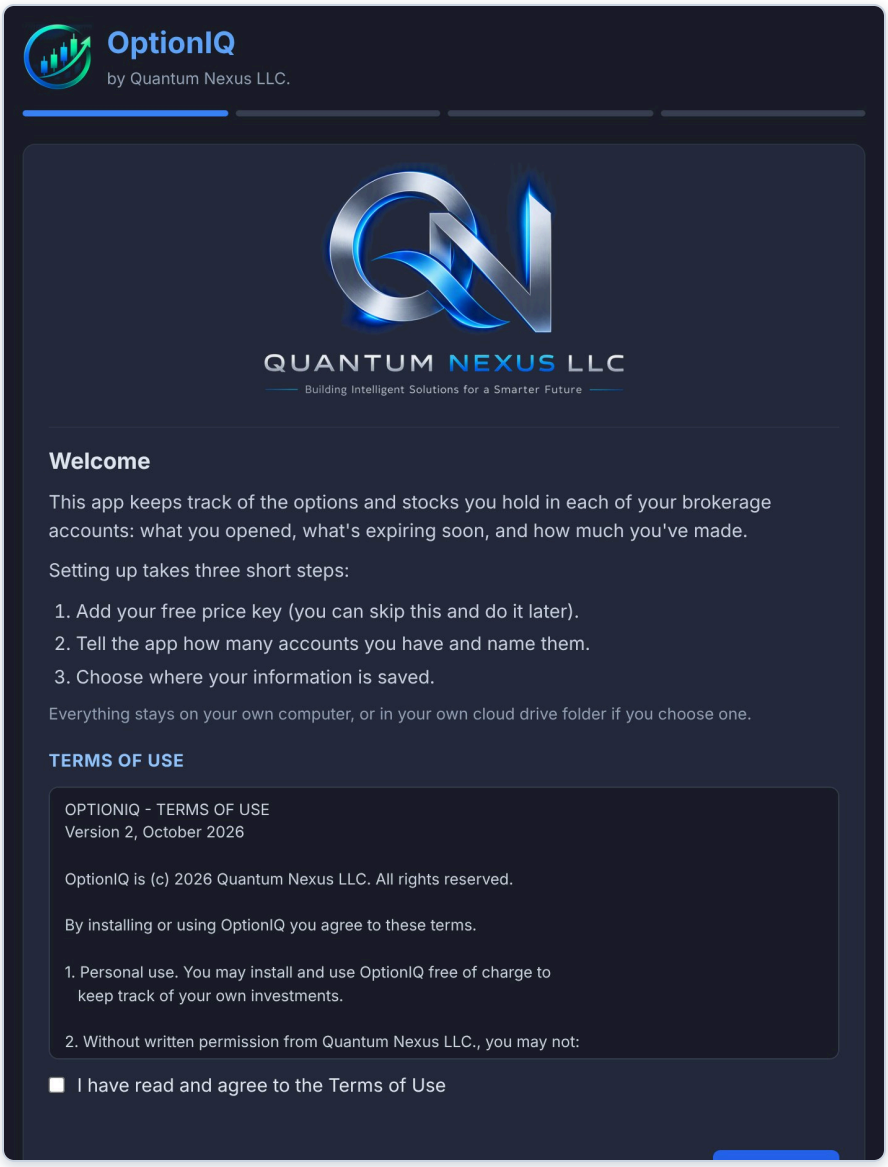
> **Tip:** OptionIQ also puts an icon on your Mac desktop. Double-click it to start the app without a Terminal window.

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3. First-time setup

The first time it opens, OptionIQ shows a short setup. You can change every answer later in ⚙️ Settings.

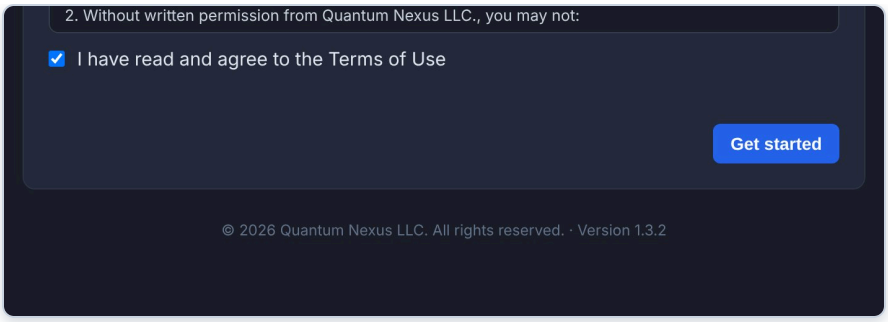
Step 1: Welcome and Terms of Use



The Welcome screen

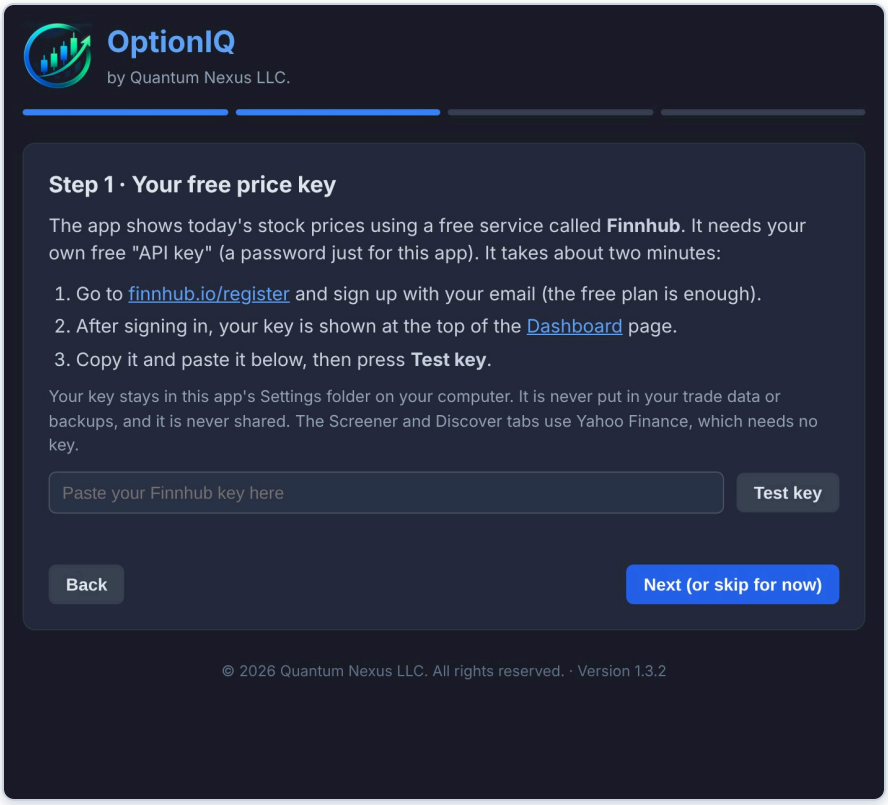
Read the Terms of Use in the box. Tick **I have read and agree to the Terms of Use**, then click **Get started**. The button stays grey until the box is ticked.

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Tick the box, then Get started turns blue

Step 2: Your free price key

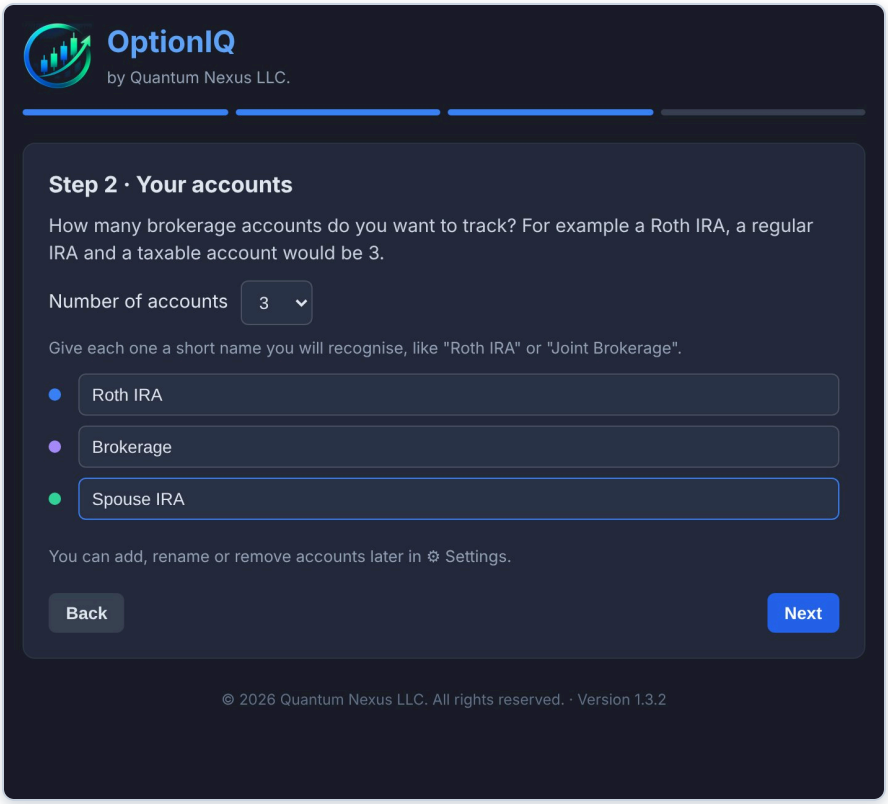


Setup step 1 of 3: the price key

Paste your free Finnhub key and click **Test key**, or click **Next (or skip for now)** and add it later. Chapter 4 shows how to get a key in about two minutes.

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Step 3: Your accounts

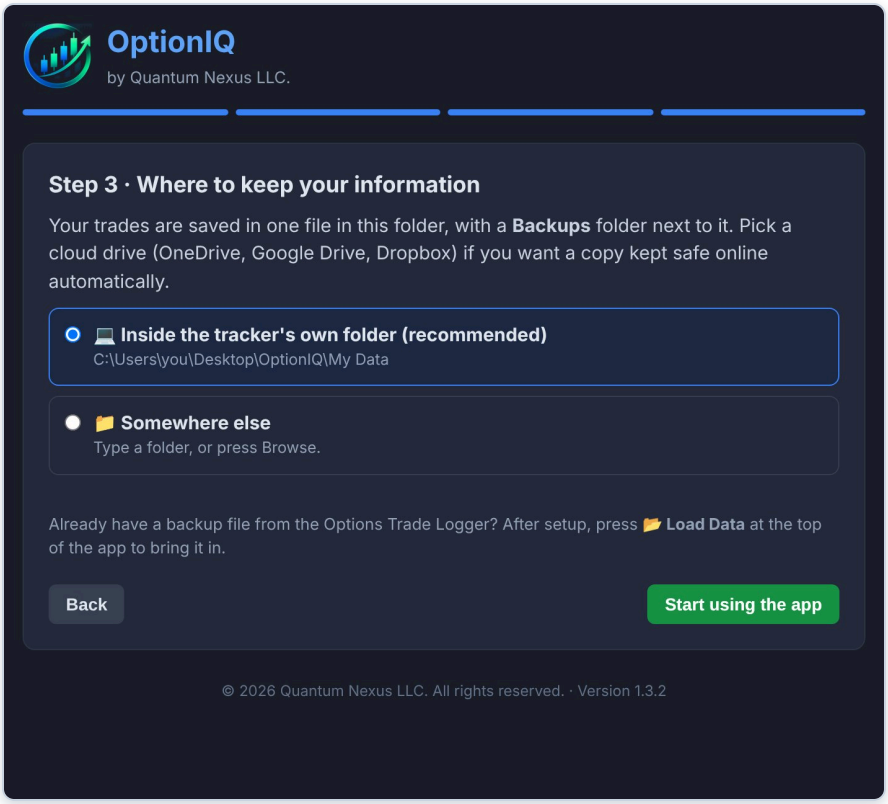


Setup step 2 of 3: choose how many accounts and name each one

Choose how many brokerage accounts you have (1 to 10) and type a short name for each, such as "Roth IRA" or "Joint Brokerage". Each account gets its own colour, used everywhere in the app.

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Step 4: Where to keep your information



Setup step 3 of 3: where your information is kept

Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)** so everything stays together, then click **Start using the app**.

Already used the browser version (Options Trade Logger)? After setup, click 📂 **Load Data** and pick your backup file. Chapter 15 explains.

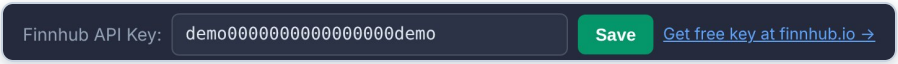
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4. Getting your free price key

A key (an "API key") is like a password that lets the app fetch today's stock prices from a free service called **Finnhub**. The 🔄 **Prices** and 🏔️ **Check ATH** buttons need it. The Screener, Analysis, Discover and Watchlist use Yahoo Finance, which needs no key.

Everyone gets their own key, free. Never share yours or use someone else's. The app never comes with a key in it.

1. In your web browser, go to **finnhub.io/register**.
2. Enter your email and a password, then click **Sign up**. If Finnhub emails you, click the link in that email to confirm.
3. Sign in. On your **Dashboard**, near the top, is **API Key** followed by a long line of letters and numbers.
4. Select that line, right-click and choose **Copy**.
5. In OptionIQ, paste it into the key box (in setup, in ⚙️ Settings → Price key, or with the 🔑 button) and click **Test key**.



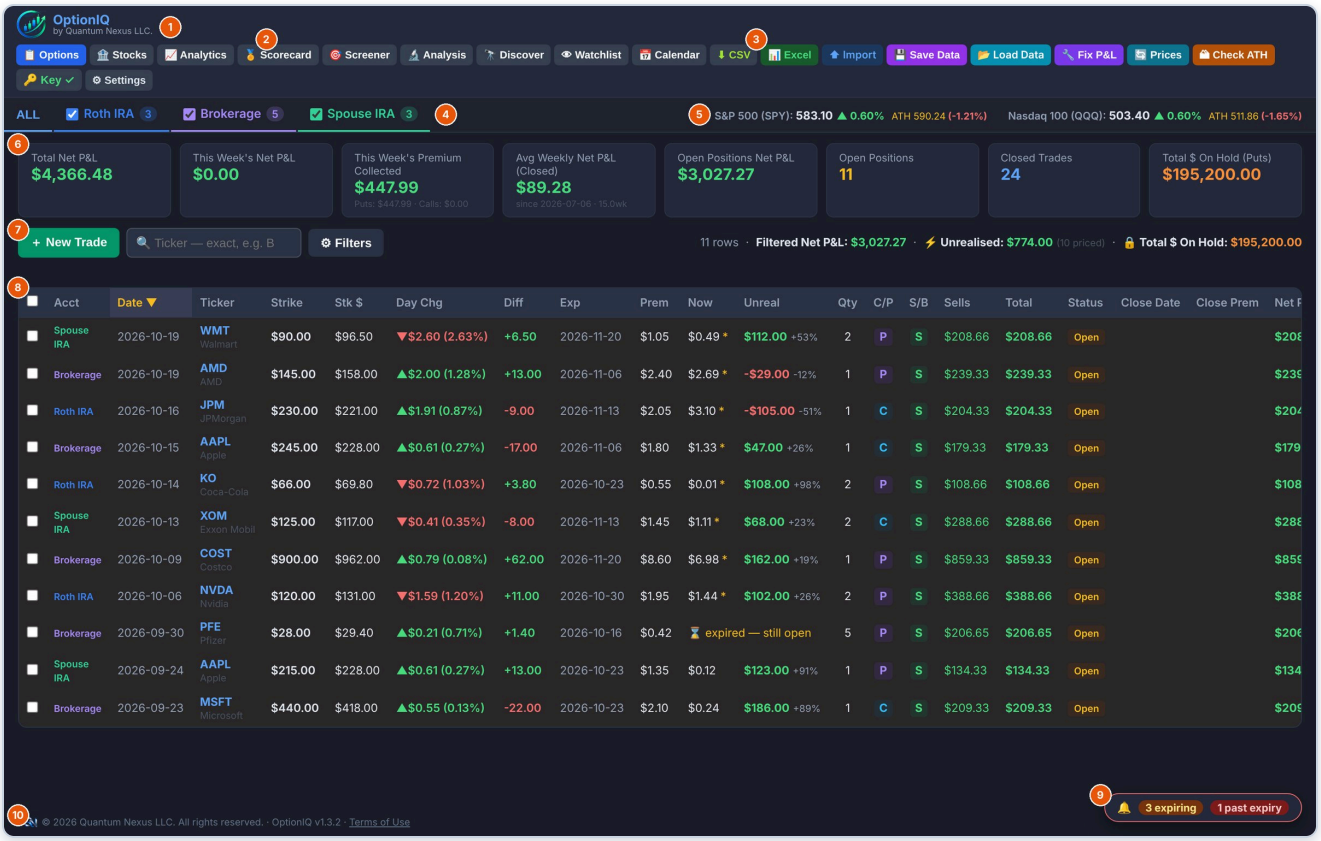
The 🔑 Key button opens this bar. Paste the key and click Save. The link opens the Finnhub sign-up page.

What the app says	What to do
The key works	Nothing. It's saved.
Finnhub didn't accept that key	It was only partly copied. Copy and paste it again.
Couldn't reach Finnhub	Check your internet connection and try again.

The free plan is enough; you never enter payment details. Your key is kept only in the app's **Settings** folder, never in your trades or backups. When a key is saved, the button reads 🔑 **Key ✔**.

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5. A tour of the main screen



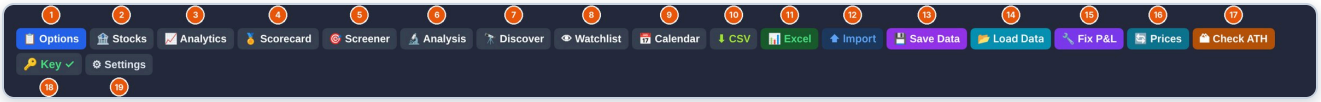
The main screen, with the Options tab open

#	Part	What it is
1	OptionIQ logo	The app's name, by Quantum Nexus LLC.
2	Tab buttons	Switch between the nine screens. The one you are on is lit up.
3	Action buttons	Export, import, back up, refresh prices and open Settings.
4	Account tabs	Choose which accounts to show.
5	Market indexes	Today's S&P 500 (SPY) and Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) prices and how far each is from its all-time high.
6	Summary cards	Your totals at a glance.
7	Toolbar	Add a trade, search, filter, and see totals for what is listed.
8	Trade list	Every trade that matches your filters.
9	🔔 Reminder button	Appears when options are expiring, past expiry, or a backup is due.

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#	Part	What it is
10	Footer	Copyright, the version you have, and the Terms of Use link.

The buttons along the top



The 19 buttons along the top

The first nine buttons switch screens. The rest do something right away.

#	Button	What it does	More in
1	📋 Options	Your option trades.	Ch. 6
2	🏦 Stocks	The shares you own.	Ch. 7
3	📈 Analytics	Charts and summaries of your trading.	Ch. 8
4	🏅 Scorecard	How well each strategy, stock and account really did.	Ch. 9
5	🎯 Screener	Finds new trades and rolls. The small number shows how many results the last run found.	Ch. 10
6	🔬 Analysis	Buy / hold / trim view of every stock you hold or watch.	Ch. 11
7	🔭 Discover	Scans the S&P 500 for new names.	Ch. 12
8	👁️ Watchlist	A health card for each stock you hold or trade.	Ch. 13
9	📅 Calendar	Your open options on the day they expire.	Ch. 14
10	⬇️ CSV	Saves trades as a spreadsheet file.	Ch. 15
11	📊 Excel	Saves a formatted Excel workbook.	Ch. 15
12	⬆ Import	Brings in option trades from a spreadsheet.	Ch. 15
13	💾 Save Data	Makes a full backup right now.	Ch. 15
14	📂 Load Data	Brings back a full backup.	Ch. 15
15	🔧 Fix P&L	Recalculates the profit on every trade.	Ch. 15
16	🔄 Prices	Fetches the latest stock and option prices.	Ch. 15
17	🏔️ Check ATH	Looks up the all-time highs of SPY and QQQ.	Ch. 15

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#	Button	What it does	More in
18	🔑 Key	Enter or change your Finnhub price key. Shows ✓ when a key is saved.	Ch. 4
19	⚙️ Settings	Accounts, backups, reminders, key, data folder and About.	Ch. 17

Account tabs and market indexes



Account tabs on the left, market indexes on the right

Each account has a coloured tab with a tick box and a small number: how many open positions it has.

- **Untick** an account to hide its trades and leave them out of the totals. Tick it again to bring it back.
- Click **ALL** to show every account together.
- The choice applies to every tab: Options, Stocks, Analytics, Scorecard and the Calendar.

On the right, **S&P 500 (SPY)** and **Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)** show today's price and change, and **ATH**: the all-time high, with how far below it the index is now. Click 🏔️ **Check ATH** to refresh the all-time highs.

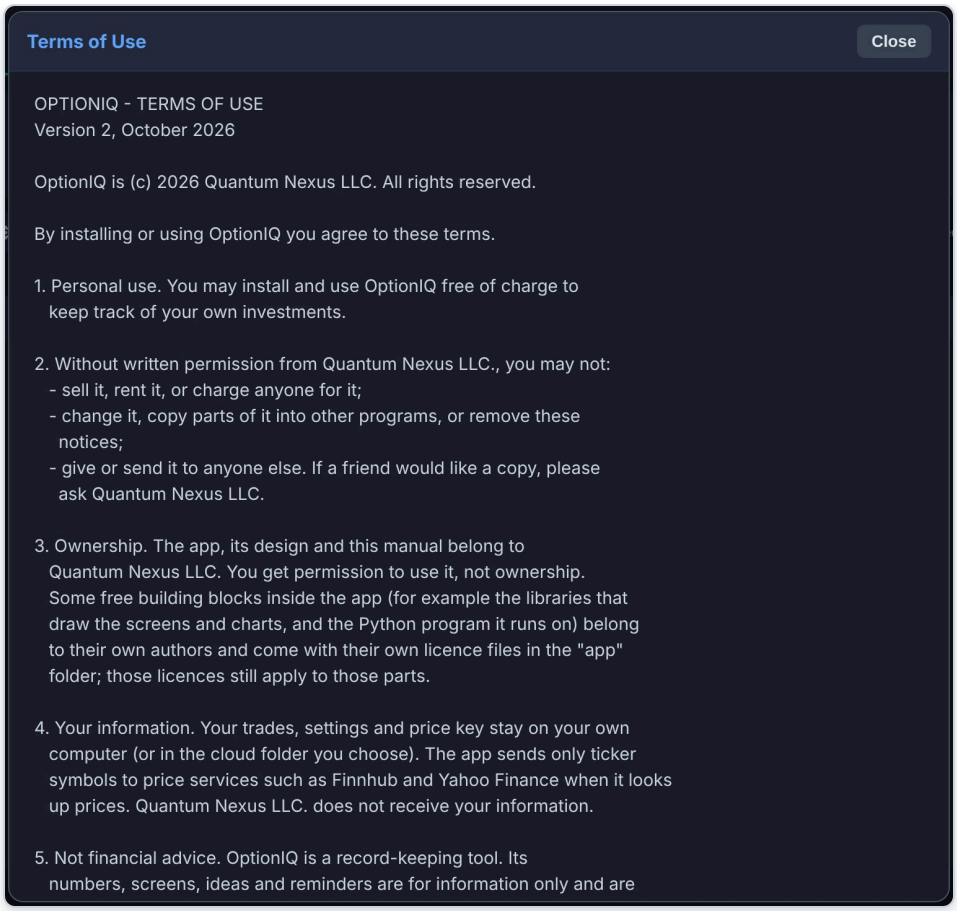
The footer



The line at the bottom of every screen

The bottom line shows the copyright, the version number you have (for example **OptionIQ v1.3.2**) and a **Terms of Use** link that opens the full terms.

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The Terms of Use window

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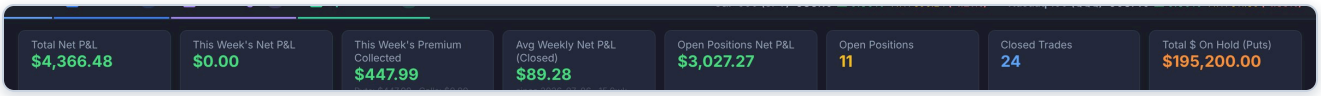
Part 2. The tabs, one by one

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6. The Options tab

This is the screen you will use most. It lists your option trades and works out your profit.

Summary cards



The eight summary cards

Card	What it shows
Total Net P&L	All profit and loss, open and closed trades, after fees.
This Week's Net P&L	Profit from trades that closed this week.
This Week's Premium Collected	Premium from options you sold this week, split into Puts and Calls underneath.
Avg Weekly Net P&L (Closed)	Average profit per week from closed trades, since your first trade.
Open Positions Net P&L	The premium you hold in trades that are still open.
Open Positions	How many trades are open.
Closed Trades	How many trades are closed.
Total $ On Hold (Puts)	Cash your broker sets aside for the puts you sold: strike × 100 × contracts.

The cards follow your account tabs: untick an account and its numbers leave the cards.

The toolbar



The Options toolbar

Part	What it does
+ New Trade	Opens the form to log a new trade (see below).
Search box	Type a ticker, for example `AAPL`, to show only that stock.
⚙️ **Filters**	Opens more ways to narrow the list. A small number shows how many filters are on, and **✕ Clear** turns them all off.
rows	How many trades are listed now.
Filtered Net P&L	Total profit of just the trades listed.
⚡ Unrealised	If you closed all listed open trades now, the profit you would keep. "(10 priced)" means 10 trades had a live option price.

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Part	What it does
💰 Money Required (Puts ITM)	Shows only when a sold put is in the money: the cash you would need if it were assigned.
🔒 Total $ On Hold	Cash set aside for the listed puts.

Filters



The Filters panel

Filter	What it does
Status	All, **Open only** (the normal choice) or Closed only.
Call/Put, Sell/Buy	Show only calls or puts, only options you sold or bought.
Ticker	Pick one stock.
Open Date From / To, Close Date From / To	Show trades opened or closed between two dates.
Min / Max Net P&L	Show only trades above or below an amount.
Max DTE, with **7d**, **14d**, **30d**	Show only options expiring within that many days. DTE means days to expiry.
Has $ On Hold	Only puts that tie up cash.
ITM Only	Only options that are in the money now.

> **Tip:** the filters stay as you left them until you click **✕ Clear**. If trades seem to be missing, check the filter count first.

The trade list

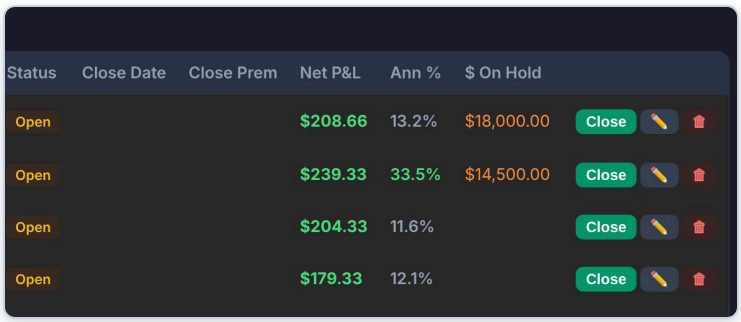
Each row is one trade. Click a column heading to sort by it; click again to reverse the order.

Column	Meaning
☐	Tick to select a row (see "Deleting several trades" below).
Acct	The account, in its colour.
Date	The day you opened the trade.
Ticker	The stock. Click it to open a price chart, with a link to **Open in Yahoo Finance ↗**.
Strike	The strike price.

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Column	Meaning
Stk $	The latest stock price (after 🔄 Prices).
Day Chg	Today's change in the stock price, in dollars and percent.
Diff	Stock price minus strike. For a sold put, a positive number is good (the stock is above the strike).
Exp	The expiry date.
Prem	The premium per share when you opened it.
Now	Today's option price per share. `*` means the middle of bid and ask; ⌛ means the price is old. "⌛ expired — still open" means the expiry date has passed but you haven't closed the trade yet.
Unreal	Profit you would keep if you closed now, with the percent of the premium already earned.
Qty	Number of contracts.
C/P, S/B	Call or Put; Sold or Bought.
Sells, Total	The premium in dollars after the fee.
Status	Open or Closed.
Close Date, Close Prem	When and for how much it was closed.
Net P&L	The profit or loss of the trade.
Ann %	Yearly rate of return for the trade. Hover for how it was worked out.
$ On Hold	Cash set aside for this put.

Row buttons

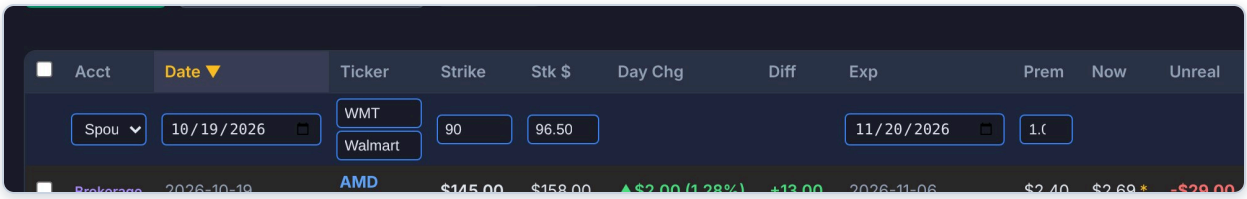


At the right end of each row: Close, edit and delete

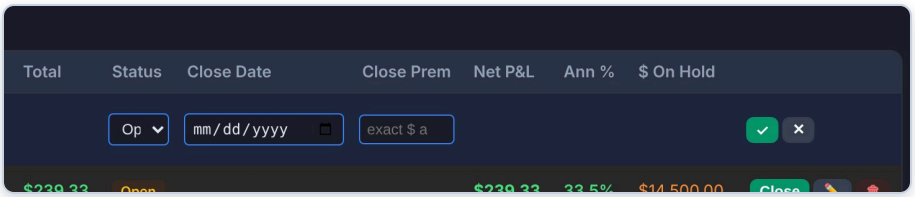
Button	What it does
Close	Opens the Close / Roll window for an open trade (see below). Closed trades don't have it.
✏️	Edit this row right in the list.
🗑️	Delete this trade. The app asks first.

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When you click ✏️, the boxes in the row become editable. Change what you need, then click ✔ to save or ✕ to cancel.

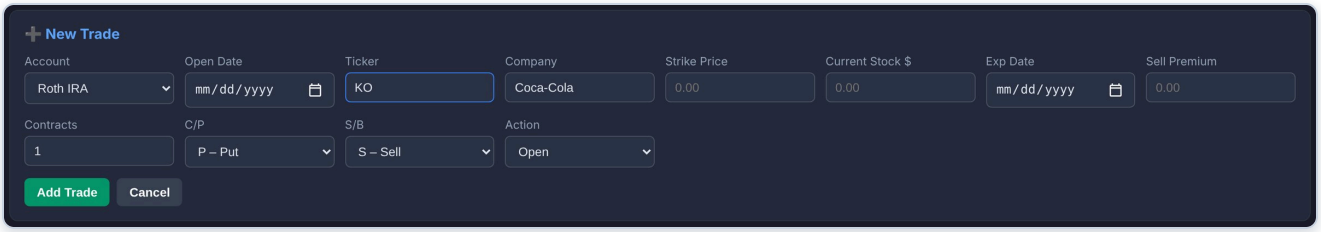


Editing a row: the left part



Editing a row: the right part, with ✓ and ✕

Logging a new trade



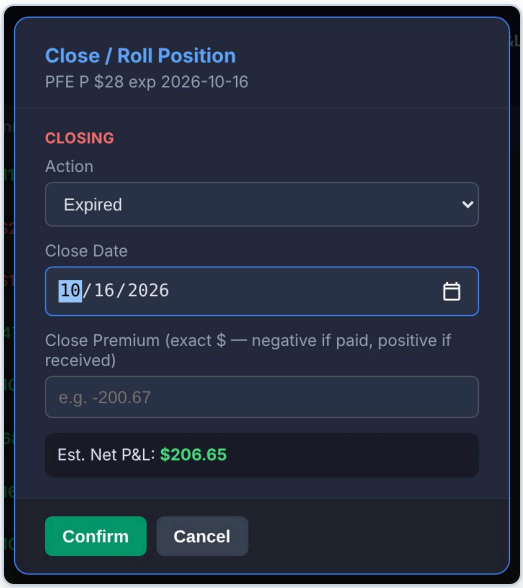
The New Trade form

Box	What to enter
Account	Which account the trade is in.
Open Date	The day you opened it (today is filled in).
Ticker	The stock symbol, for example KO.
Company	Filled in for you from the ticker.
Strike Price	The strike.
Current Stock $	The stock price when you traded (optional).
Exp Date	The expiry date.
Sell Premium	The premium per share.
Contracts	How many contracts.
C/P	Call or Put.
S/B	Sell (you received the premium) or Buy (you paid it).
Action	Leave as **Open** for a new trade.

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The line under the form shows what the trade collects (**Sells**) and, for a put, the cash it puts **On Hold**. Click **Add Trade** to save it, or **Cancel**.

Closing or rolling a trade



The Close / Roll window

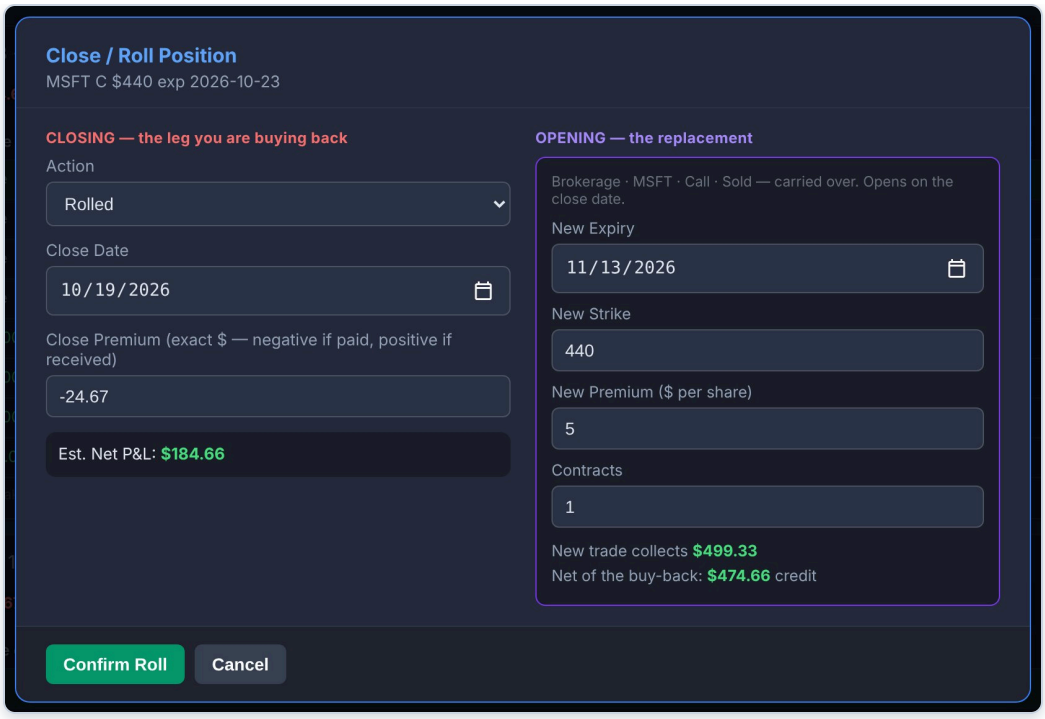
Click **Close** on an open trade. Choose what happened in **Action**:

Action	When to use it
Expired	The option ran out worthless. You keep the whole premium.
Assigned	Your sold put was exercised and you bought the shares. The app adds the shares to 🏦 Stocks for you (100 × contracts, at the strike price).
Called Away	Your covered call was exercised and your shares were sold. The app asks, then sells the shares from your oldest lot.
Bought to Close	You bought the option back before expiry.
Sold to Close	You sold an option you had bought.
Rolled	You bought it back and sold a new one on the same stock.

Fill in **Close Date** and **Close Premium**: the exact dollars for all contracts, **negative if you paid**, positive if you received money. Leave it 0 for Expired, Assigned and Called Away. **Est. Net P&L** shows the result. Click **Confirm** to save, or **Cancel**.

When you choose **Rolled**, a second part opens on the right: **OPENING — the replacement**. Fill in the **New Expiry**, **New Strike**, **New Premium** and **Contracts**. The window shows what the new trade collects and the **Net of the buy-back** (a credit is good). Click **Confirm Roll**. The old trade is closed, the new one is logged, and the two are linked so the 🏅 Scorecard can show the whole roll as one chain.

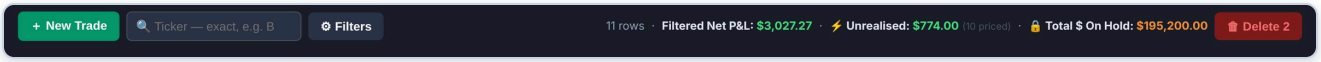
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Rolling: the replacement trade on the right

> **Careful:** for a **call** that was assigned, choose **Called Away**, not Assigned. If a call is marked Assigned, the app reminds you to sell the shares yourself on 🏦 Stocks → Sell.

Deleting several trades

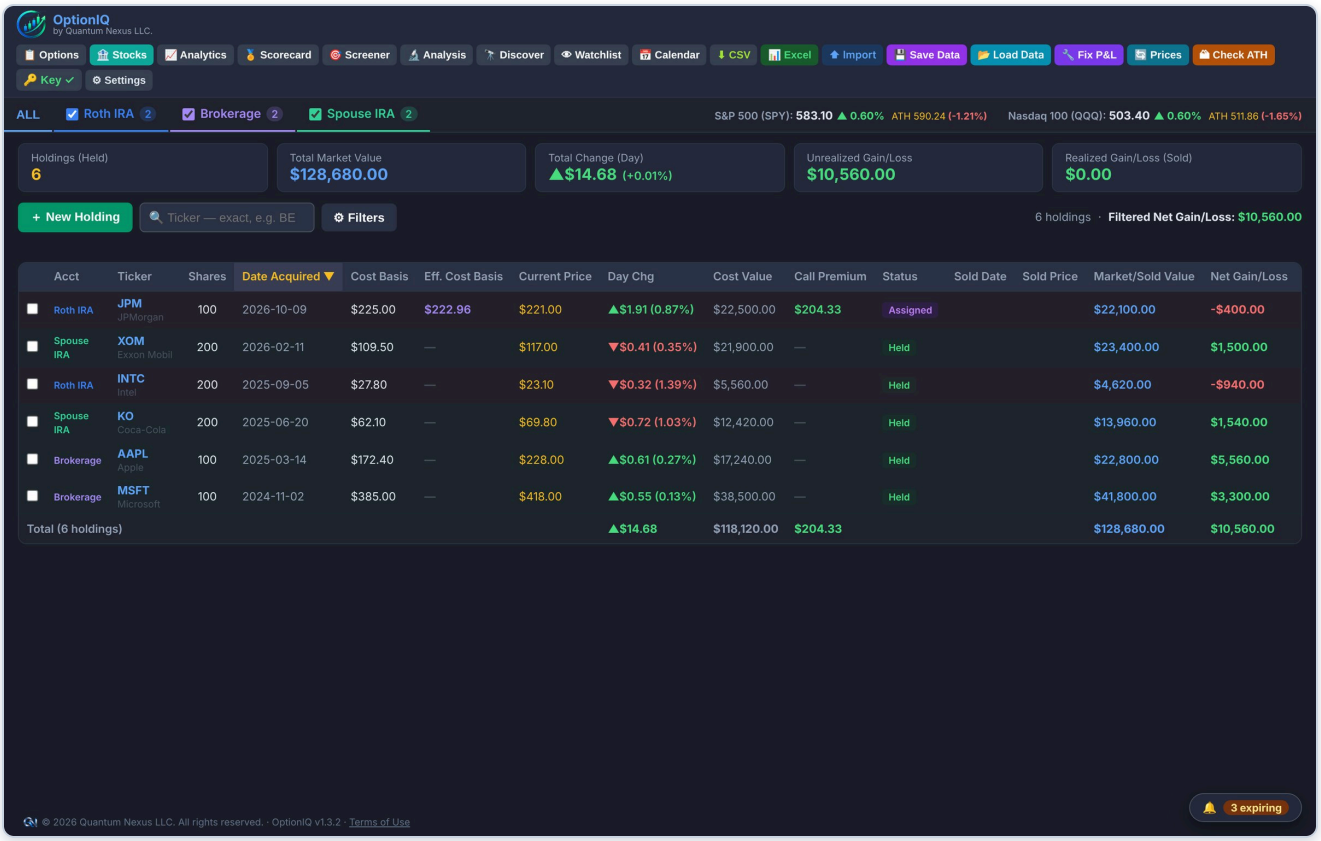


Tick rows and a red Delete button appears

Tick the box at the start of several rows. A red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears in the toolbar. Click it to delete them all (the app asks first). **Careful:** deleting can't be undone, so press 💾 Save Data first.

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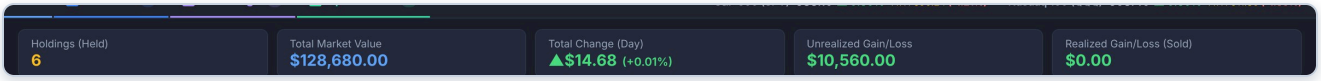
7. The Stocks tab



The Stocks tab

This tab lists the shares you own in each account, and shares you have sold.

Summary cards



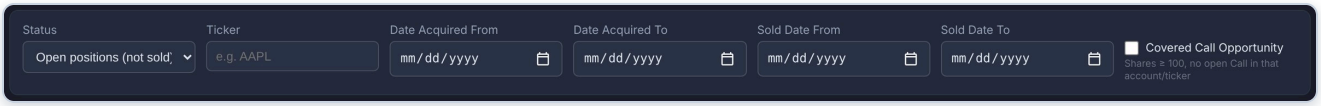
The Stocks summary cards

Card	What it shows
Holdings (Held)	How many holdings you still own.
Total Market Value	What they are worth at today's prices.
Total Change (Day)	How much their value moved today.
Unrealized Gain/Loss	Gain or loss on shares you still own.
Realized Gain/Loss (Sold)	Gain or loss on shares you have sold.

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Toolbar and filters

The toolbar has **+ New Holding**, a search box, ⚙️ **Filters**, the number of holdings listed, and **Filtered Net Gain/Loss**. When you tick rows, a red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears, just as on the Options tab.



The Stocks filters

Filter	What it does
Status	All, Open positions (not sold), Held only, Assigned only, or Sold only.
Ticker	Pick one stock.
Date Acquired From / To, Sold Date From / To	Narrow by date.
Covered Call Opportunity	Shows only holdings with at least 100 shares and no open call on them: shares you could sell a covered call on.

The holdings list

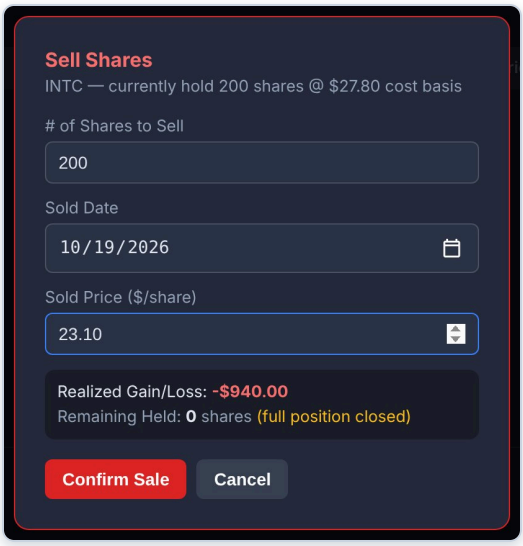
Column	Meaning
Shares, Date Acquired	How many shares and when you got them.
Cost Basis	What you paid per share.
Eff. Cost Basis	Your cost after subtracting the call premium you collected on these shares.
Current Price, Day Chg	Today's price and change.
Cost Value	Shares × cost basis.
Call Premium	For assigned shares: premium earned from calls sold on them.
Status	Held, Assigned (from a put) or Sold.
Sold Date, Sold Price	For sold shares.
Market/Sold Value	Value now, or what you sold for.
Net Gain/Loss, %	Your gain or loss in dollars and percent.



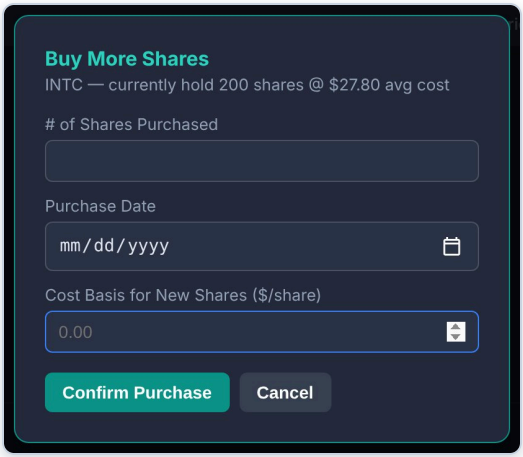
Row buttons: Buy More, Sell, edit and delete

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Button	What it does
Buy More	Add shares to a holding. The window shows the **New Total Shares** and **New Average Cost Basis**.
Sell	Sell some or all shares. The window shows the **Realized Gain/Loss** and how many remain held.
✏️ / 🗑️	Edit or delete the holding.

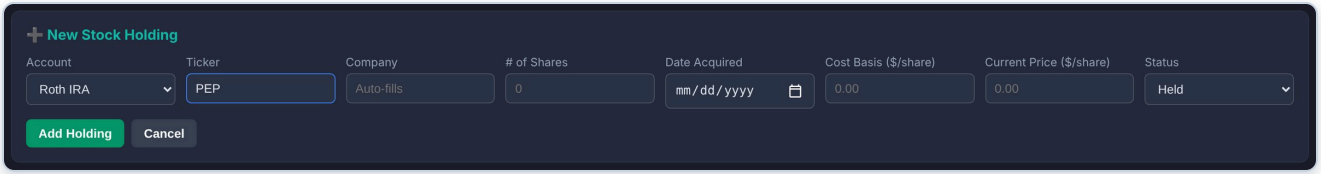


Sell Shares window



Buy More Shares window

Adding a holding



The New Stock Holding form

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Click **+ New Holding** and fill in the **Account**, **Ticker** (the company name fills in), **# of Shares**, **Date Acquired**, **Cost Basis** per share, **Current Price** (optional; 🔄 Prices fills it in) and **Status** (Held, Assigned (from Put) or Sold). Click **Add Holding** to save.

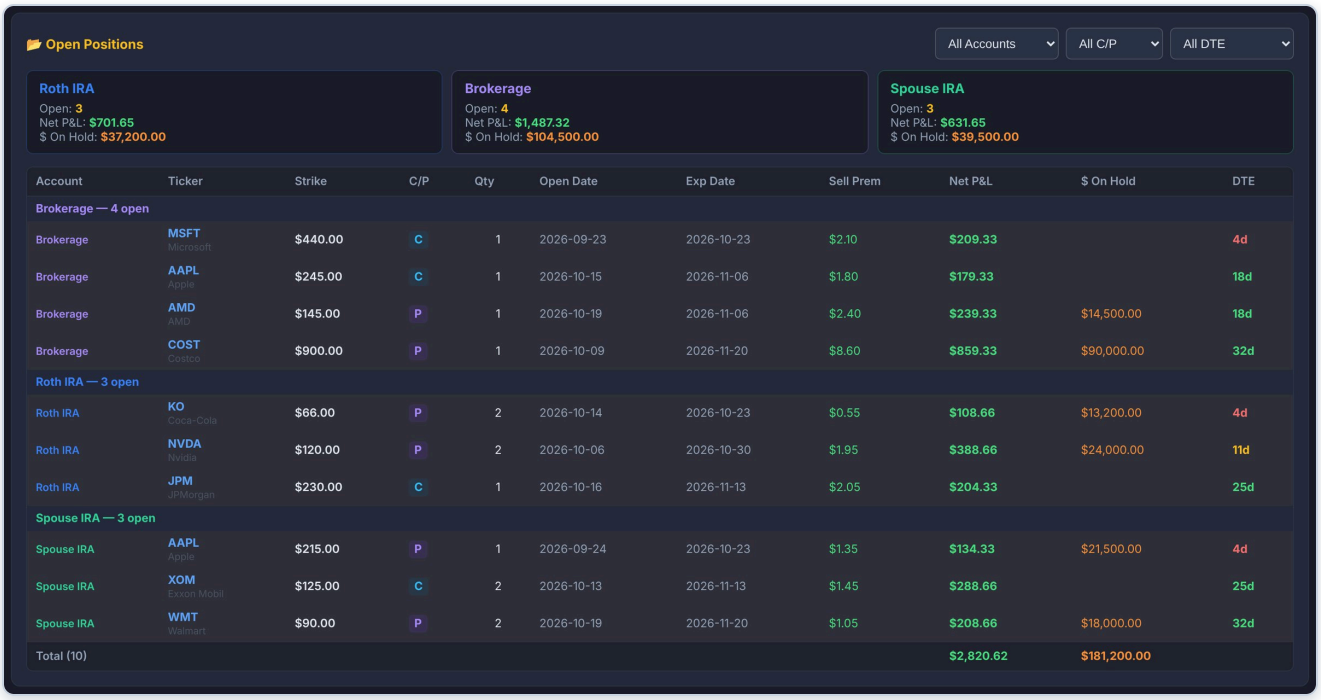
> **Tip:** shares you get from an assigned put are added for you when you close the put as **Assigned**. You don't need to add them by hand.

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8. The Analytics tab

Analytics shows your trading in tables and charts. Every part follows the account tabs at the top.

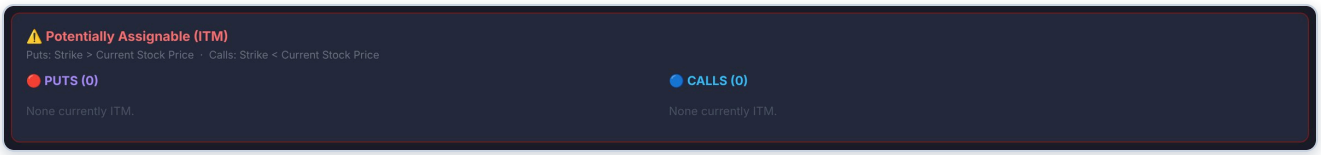
Open positions



Open Positions, grouped by account

Use the drop-downs at the top right to show **All Accounts** or one, **All C/P** or only calls or puts, and **All DTE** or only options expiring within 7, 14 or 30 days. Each account card shows how many trades are open, their Net P&L and the cash on hold. The table groups open trades by account, with **DTE** (days to expiry) in the last column: red when it is very close.

Potentially assignable (in the money)

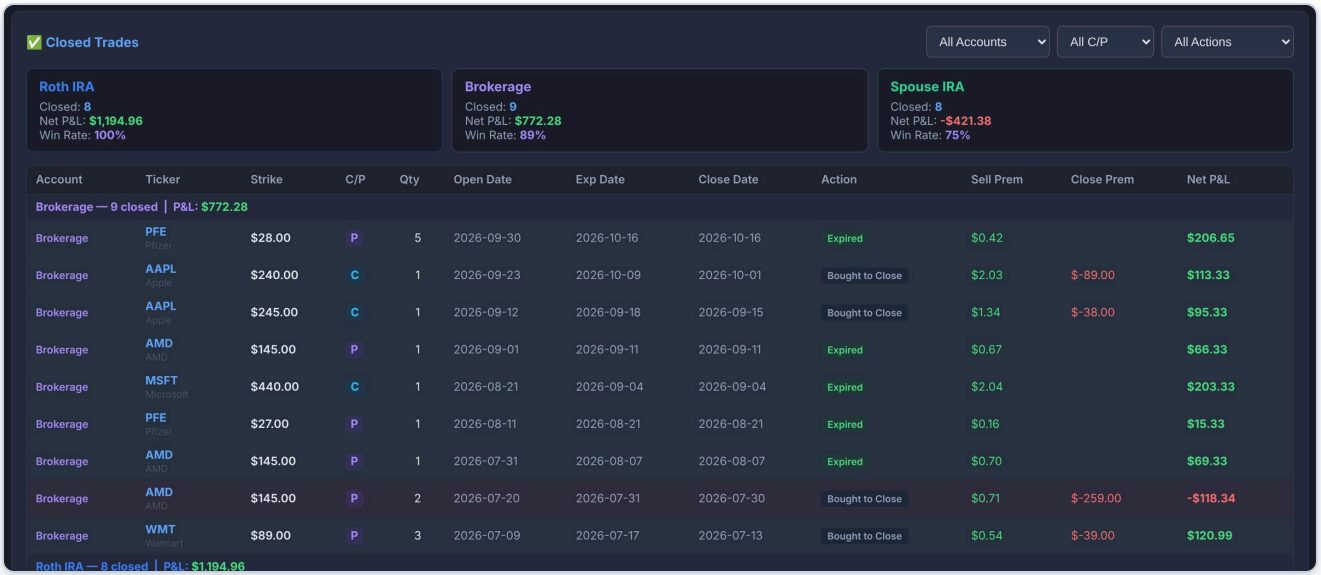


Puts and calls that are in the money

This box lists sold **puts** whose stock is now below the strike, and sold **calls** whose stock is above the strike. These could be assigned. "None currently ITM" means nothing is at risk right now.

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Closed trades



Closed trades, with a win rate per account

Filter by account, call/put and **Action** (Expired, Bought to Close, and so on). Each account card shows the number of closed trades, Net P&L and **Win Rate**: the percent of closed trades that made money. Losing trades are tinted red.

Charts



P&L by Ticker

P&L by Ticker shows total profit for each stock, best first. Red bars are losses.



P&L by Month

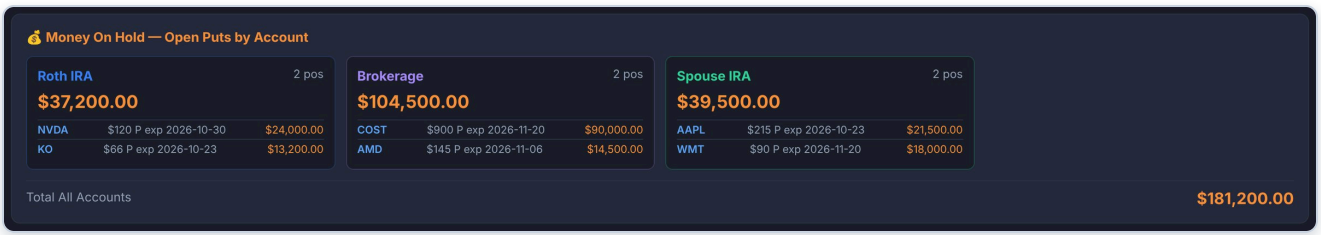
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P&L by Month shows profit for each calendar month.



P&L by Week, with a running total line

P&L by Week shows a green or red bar for each week (closed trades, by the Friday of that week) and an orange line for the running total.



Money On Hold, open puts by account

Money On Hold shows the cash set aside for open puts in each account, the puts that make it up, and the total.



Weekly Premium Collected, Puts vs Calls, and Premium by Account

Weekly Premium Collected shows the premium you received each week from puts (purple) and calls (blue). **Premium Collected by Account** totals it for each account since you started.

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9. The Scorecard tab

The Scorecard answers "how well is this really working?" It looks at the money you put at risk and how long it was at risk, not just the dollars you kept.

Headline cards



The four headline numbers

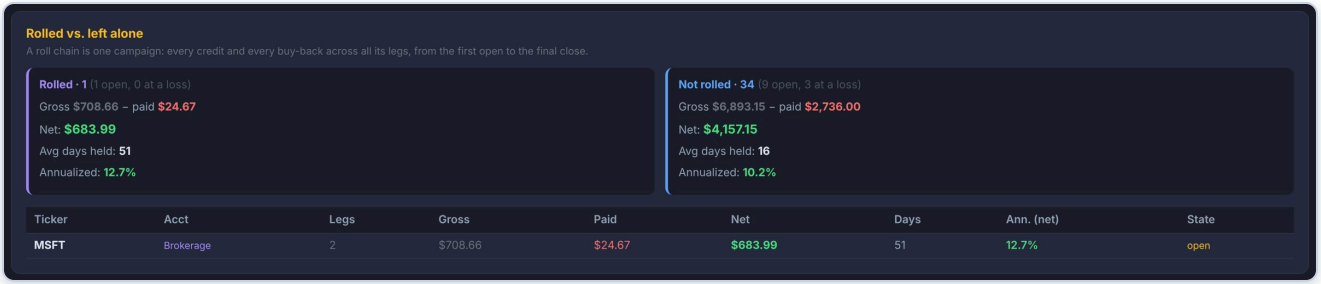
Card	Meaning
Annualized on capital at risk	Your net premium as a yearly rate on the money at risk, weighted by how long it was at risk.
Net premium kept	Premium received minus what you paid to close.
Gross premium	All premium received.
Period	From your first trade to today.



How the Scorecard ties back to the Options tab

How this reconciles with the Options tab shows the sum: gross premium minus what you paid to close equals net, which matches the Options tab's Total Net P&L.

Rolled vs. left alone

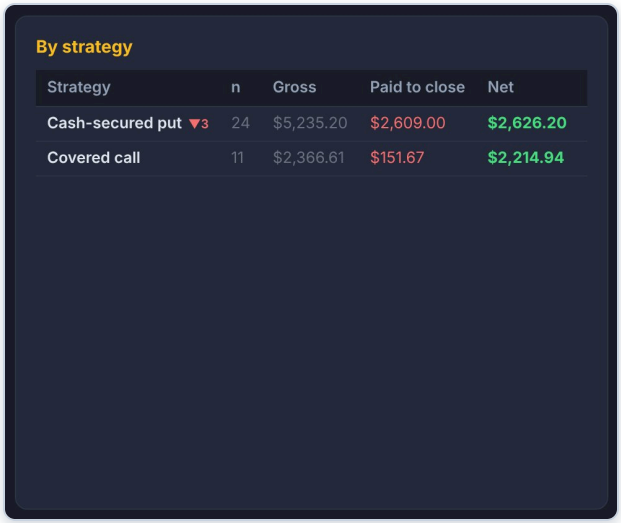


Rolls are counted as one chain from first open to final close

A roll chain is treated as one campaign: every credit and every buy-back across all its legs, from the first open to the final close. The two boxes compare trades you **rolled** with trades you **left alone**, and the table lists each chain. Chains are linked only when you roll with the **Rolled** action in the Close window.

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By strategy, underlying and account

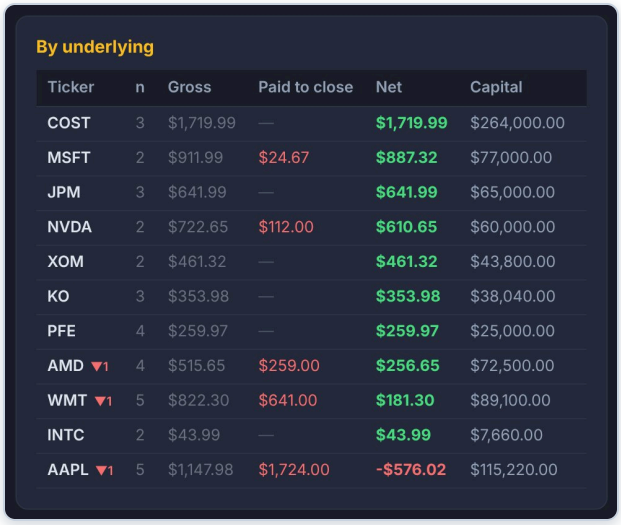


By strategy

Strategy	n	Gross	Paid to close	Net
Cash-secured put ▼3	24	$5,235.20	$2,609.00	$2,626.20
Covered call	11	$2,366.61	$151.67	$2,214.94

Results by strategy, by stock, and by account

Three tables split results by **strategy** (cash-secured put, covered call), by **underlying** stock and by **account**. A small red ▼ with a number shows how many losing trades are in that row. **Capital** is the money that was at risk.

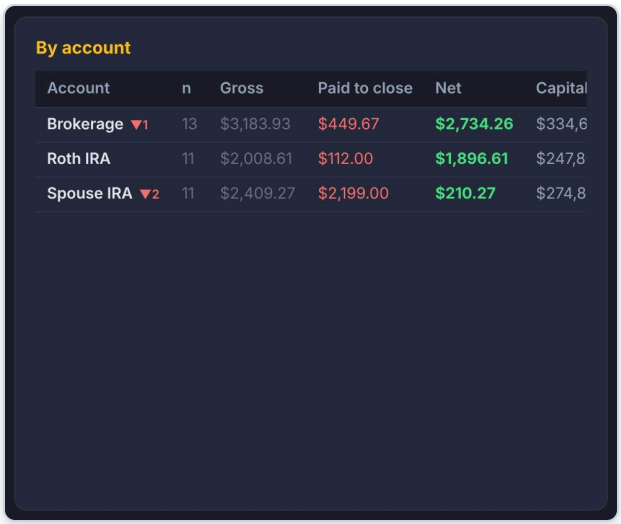


By underlying

Ticker	n	Gross	Paid to close	Net	Capital
COST	3	$1,719.99	—	$1,719.99	$264,000.00
MSFT	2	$911.99	$24.67	$887.32	$77,000.00
JPM	3	$641.99	—	$641.99	$65,000.00
NVDA	2	$722.65	$112.00	$610.65	$60,000.00
XOM	2	$461.32	—	$461.32	$43,800.00
KO	3	$353.98	—	$353.98	$38,040.00
PFE	4	$259.97	—	$259.97	$25,000.00
AMD ▼1	4	$515.65	$259.00	$256.65	$72,500.00
WMT ▼1	5	$822.30	$641.00	$181.30	$89,100.00
INTC	2	$43.99	—	$43.99	$7,660.00
AAPL ▼1	5	$1,147.98	$1,724.00	-$576.02	$115,220.00

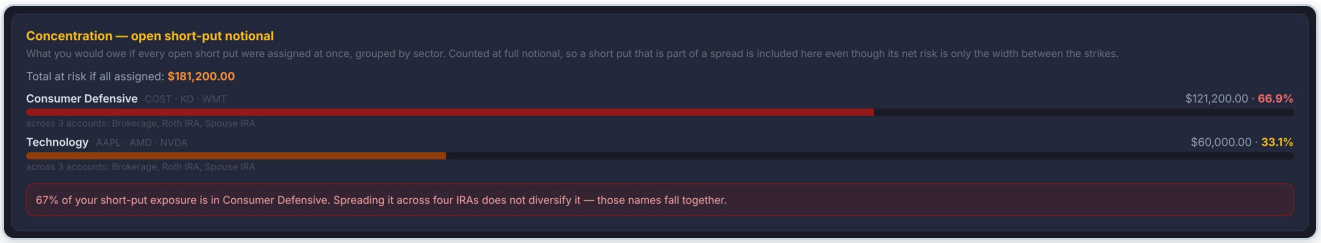
By underlying

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By account

Concentration



How much of your put risk sits in each sector

If every open put were assigned at once, how much stock would you have to buy, and in which sectors? A red warning appears when too much sits in one sector. Sectors come from the 🔬 Analysis tab, so run it once first; until then everything shows as Unclassified.

Against simply holding the index



Your return compared with SPY and QQQ

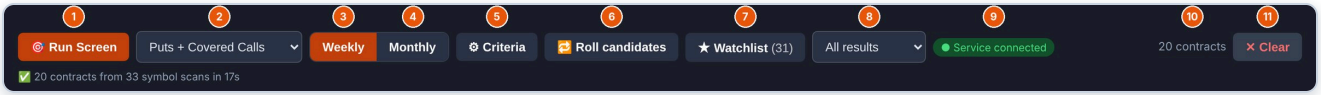
Click 📊 **Fetch SPY / QQQ** (later 🔄 **Refresh**) to compare your yearly return with simply owning the S&P 500 (SPY) or Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) over the same dates. It needs the Screener service.

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10. The Screener tab

The Screener looks for new trades to place: **cash-secured puts** on the stocks in your watchlist, and **covered calls** on shares you hold. It also suggests **rolls** for options you already have. It uses free Yahoo Finance data, so it needs no key, but it needs the internet and the one-time download from Chapter 2.

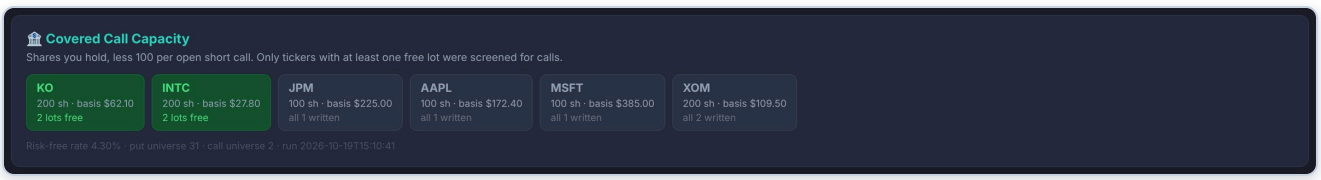
The Screener bar



The Screener bar

#	Button	What it does
1	🎯 Run Screen	Checks every ticker on your watchlist and lists the contracts that pass your rules. Takes from a few seconds to a minute.
2	Side	**Puts + Covered Calls**, **Cash-Secured Puts only** or **Covered Calls only**.
3	Weekly	Fills in rules for short trades: 4 to 14 days, delta 0.10 to 0.25, at least $40 per contract.
4	Monthly	Fills in rules for longer trades: 21 to 45 days, delta 0.15 to 0.30, at least $75 per contract. If you change any rule, neither button is lit ("Custom").
5	⚙️ Criteria	Opens all the rules (below).
6	🔁 Roll candidates	Suggests rolls for options you hold (below).
7	★ Watchlist (31)	Opens the list of tickers the Screener checks.
8	Results filter	Show **All results**, **Puts only** or **Calls only**.
9	Service connected	Green means the Screener's helper is running. If it is red, click ↻ **Retry**, or close and reopen the app.
10	contracts	How many contracts are listed.
11	✕ Clear	Clears the results.

Covered Call Capacity



Covered Call Capacity: which holdings have shares free for a call

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Each card is a stock you hold. Green cards have at least one free lot of 100 shares that is not already covered by a call, so the Screener looks for calls on them. Grey cards say why not: "all 1 written" (every lot already has a call) or "under 100 sh".

The results



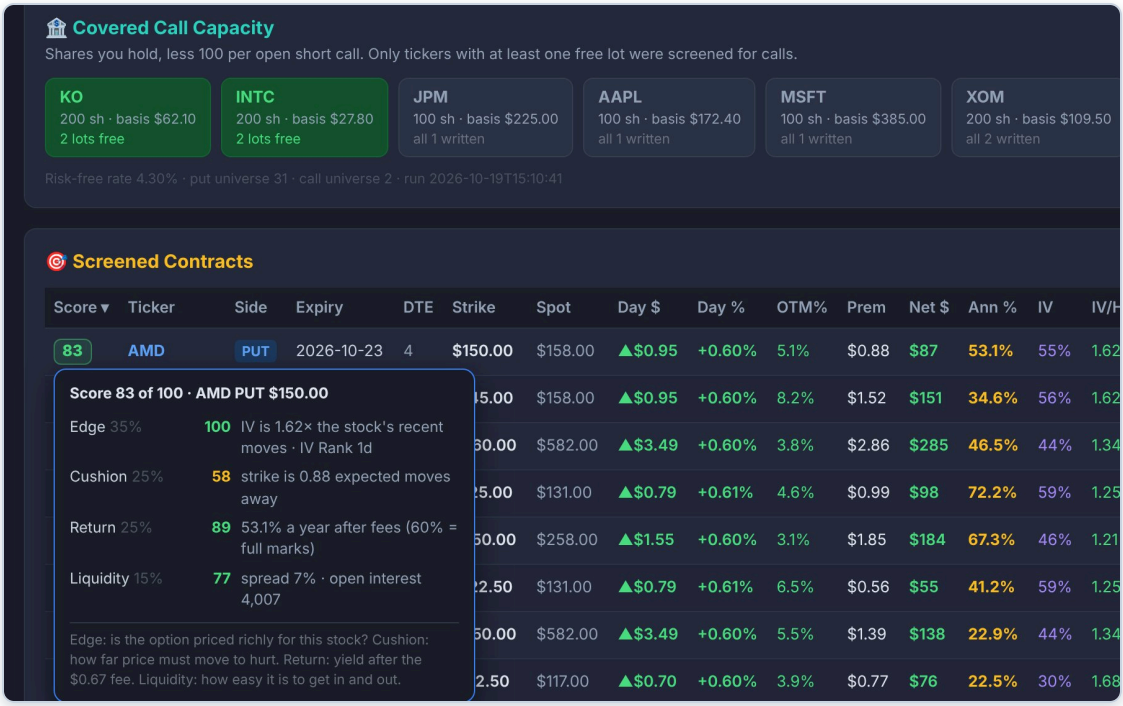
Screened contracts, best score first

Each row is one option contract you could sell. The list is sorted by **Score**, best first.

Column	Meaning
Score	0 to 100. Hover over it to see why (below).
Ticker and flags	⚠ earnings before expiry; 💲 a dividend before expiry; ⚖️ you already have a lot in this sector; ⛰️ the strike sits near a price level the stock has bounced off before.
Side	PUT or CALL.
Expiry, DTE	Expiry date and days to expiry.
Strike, Spot	Strike price and today's stock price.
Day $, Day %	Today's stock move.
OTM%	How far the strike is from today's price. Bigger means safer, but less premium.
Prem, Net $	Premium per share, and dollars per contract after the $0.67 fee.
Ann %	Yearly rate of return if it expires worthless.
IV, IV/HV, IVR	How richly the option is priced: implied volatility, compared with how much the stock has actually moved, and with its own past year (IV Rank). IVR needs about 60 days of history, which the app collects by itself while it is open; until then it shows how many days it has.
Δ	Delta: roughly the chance the option ends in the money. 0.20 is about a 1-in-5 chance.
PoP	Probability of profit.
OI, Spr%	Open interest and bid/ask spread: how easy it is to trade.

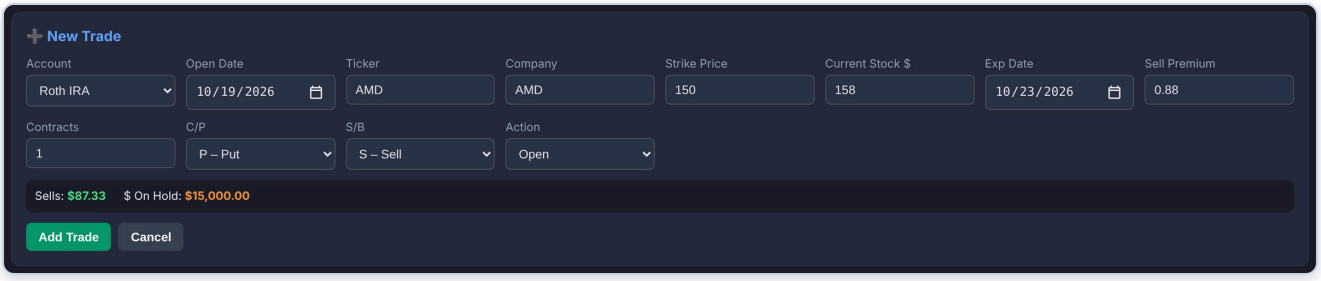
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Column	Meaning
P/E	Price to earnings ratio of the stock.
Free, Basis, vs Basis	For covered calls: free lots, your cost basis, and how far the strike is above it.
B/E	Break-even price.
+ Log	Opens the New Trade form on the Options tab, already filled in. Check it and click **Add Trade**.



Hover over a Score to see how it was worked out

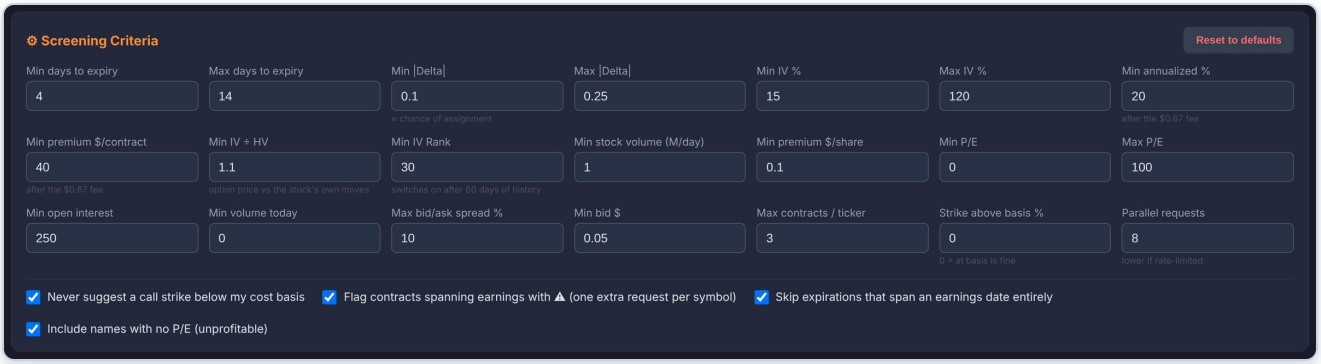
The Score adds up four things: **Edge** (35%): is the option priced richly for this stock; **Cushion** (25%): how far the price must move before it hurts; **Return** (25%): the yearly return after the fee; and **Liquidity** (15%): how easy it is to get in and out.



+ Log fills in the New Trade form for you

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Screening criteria

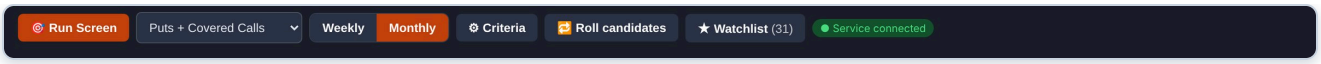


All the Screener rules

Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to see and change every rule. **Weekly** and **Monthly** fill them in for you; change any box to make your own. **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

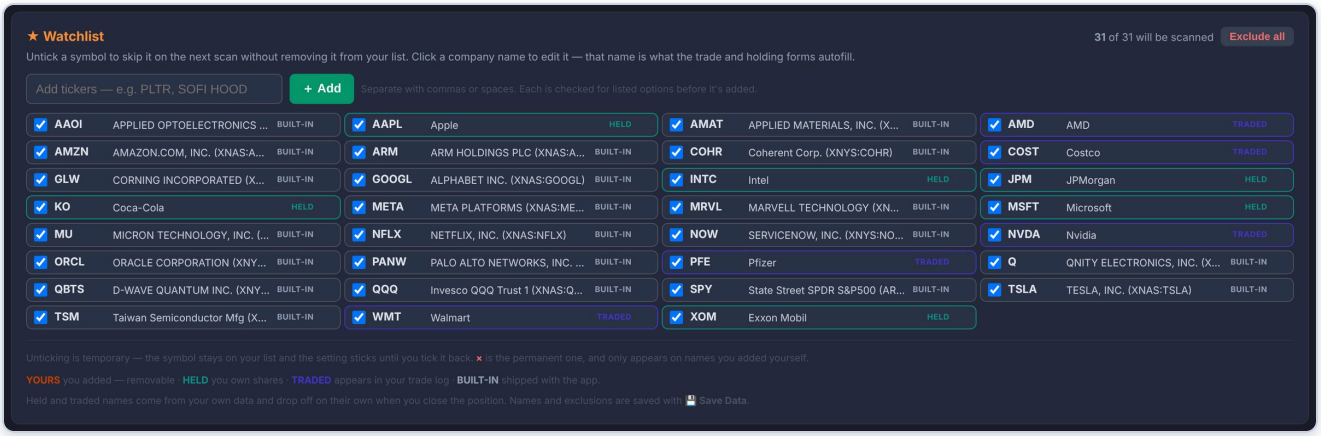
Rule	What it means
Min / Max days to expiry	How soon the option must expire.
Min / Max |Delta|	How likely it is to end in the money. Lower is safer.
Min / Max IV %	How richly priced the option must be.
Min annualized %	The lowest yearly return to show, after the fee.
Min premium $/contract, Min premium $/share	Skip options that pay too little.
Min IV ÷ HV	Option price compared with how the stock actually moves. Above 1 means the option is rich.
Min IV Rank	Only used once 60 days of history exist.
Min stock volume (M/day)	Skip thinly traded stocks.
Min / Max P/E	Company valuation limits.
Min open interest, Min volume today, Max bid/ask spread %, Min bid $	Skip contracts that are hard to trade at a fair price.
Max contracts / ticker	How many results per stock at most.
Strike above basis %	For covered calls: how far above your cost the strike must be.
Parallel requests	How many tickers to check at once. Leave it as it is.
Never suggest a call strike below my cost basis	Protects you from selling shares at a loss.
Flag contracts spanning earnings with ⚠	Marks options that expire after an earnings report.
Skip expirations that span an earnings date entirely	Hides them instead.
Include names with no P/E (unprofitable)	Untick to skip companies that lose money.

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Monthly lit up: the Monthly rules are in use

Your Screener watchlist

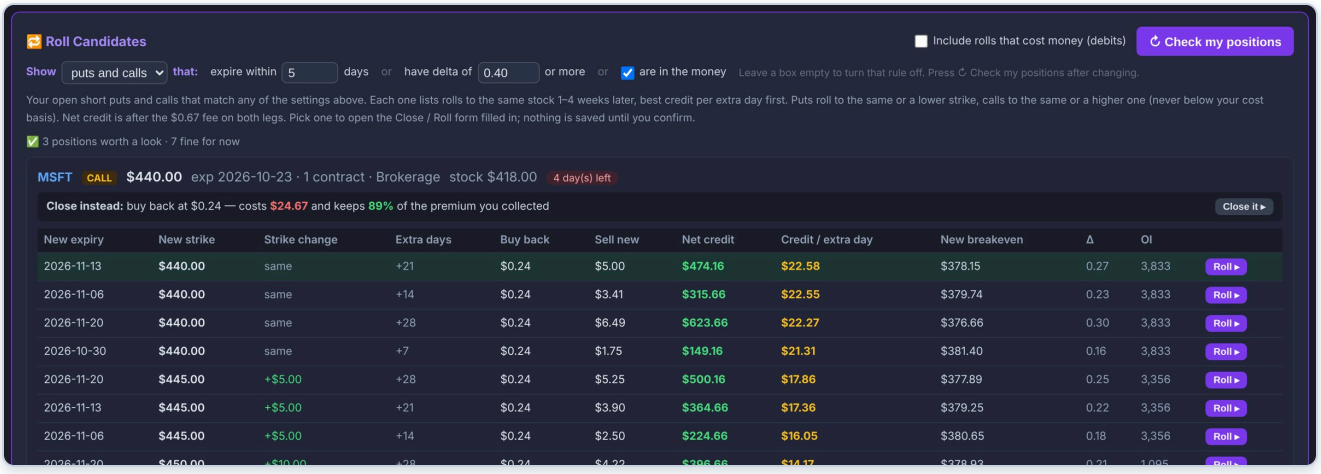


The Screener watchlist

The Screener checks every ticked name in this list.

- Type tickers in the box (for example `PLTR, SOFI`) and click **+ Add**.
- **Untick** a name to skip it on the next run without removing it. **Include all** / **Exclude all** tick or untick them all.
- **×** removes a name you added yourself.
- The tags show where a name came from: **YOURS** (you added it), **HELD** (you own shares), **TRADED** (in your trade log), **BUILT-IN** (comes with the app).
- Click a company name to edit it. That name is what the trade and holding forms fill in.

Roll candidates



Roll candidates for options close to expiry

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Click 🔁 **Roll candidates** to get ideas for options you already hold.

1. In the line at the top, choose **Show** puts and calls, puts only or calls only, and which positions to check: those that **expire within** a number of days, **have delta of** a number **or more**, or **are in the money**. A position shows if it matches any rule that is on. Leave a box empty, or untick in the money, to turn that rule off.
2. Tick **Include rolls that cost money (debits)** if you also want to see rolls that cost you money.
3. Click ↻ **Check my positions**.

Each position shows a **Close instead** line: what buying it back would cost, and how much of the premium you would keep, with a **Close it ▸** button. Below it is a table of rolls to the same stock 1 to 4 weeks later, the best **credit per extra day** first:

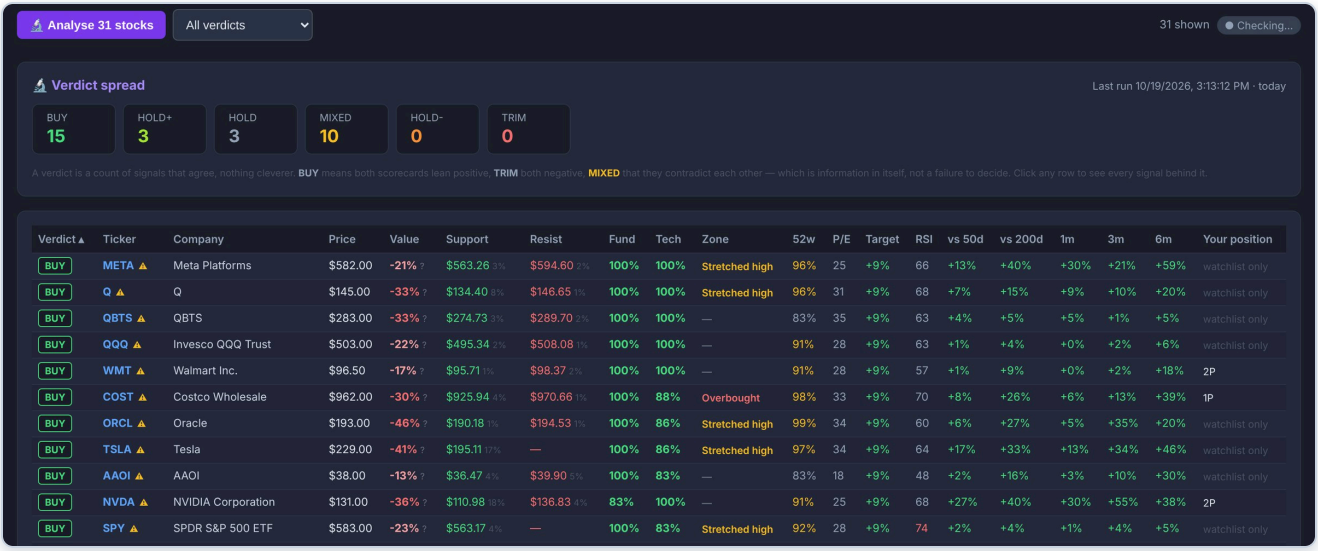
Column	Meaning
New expiry, New strike, Strike change	The replacement option.
Extra days	How much longer you would hold it.
Buy back, Sell new	Price to close the old one, and premium for the new one.
Net credit	What you collect overall for one contract.
Credit / extra day	Net credit divided by extra days. Higher is better.
New breakeven, Δ, OI	Break-even after the roll, delta and open interest of the new option.

Click **Roll ▸** on a row to open the Close / Roll window already filled in (Chapter 6). Nothing is saved until you click **Confirm Roll**.

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11. The Analysis tab

Analysis gives a quick health check of every stock you hold or watch, based on the company's numbers and its price chart.



The Analysis tab after a run

- Click 🔬 **Analyse N stocks** to start. **✕ Cancel** stops a run. Use the drop-down to show only one verdict.
- The **Verdict spread** cards count how many stocks got each verdict.

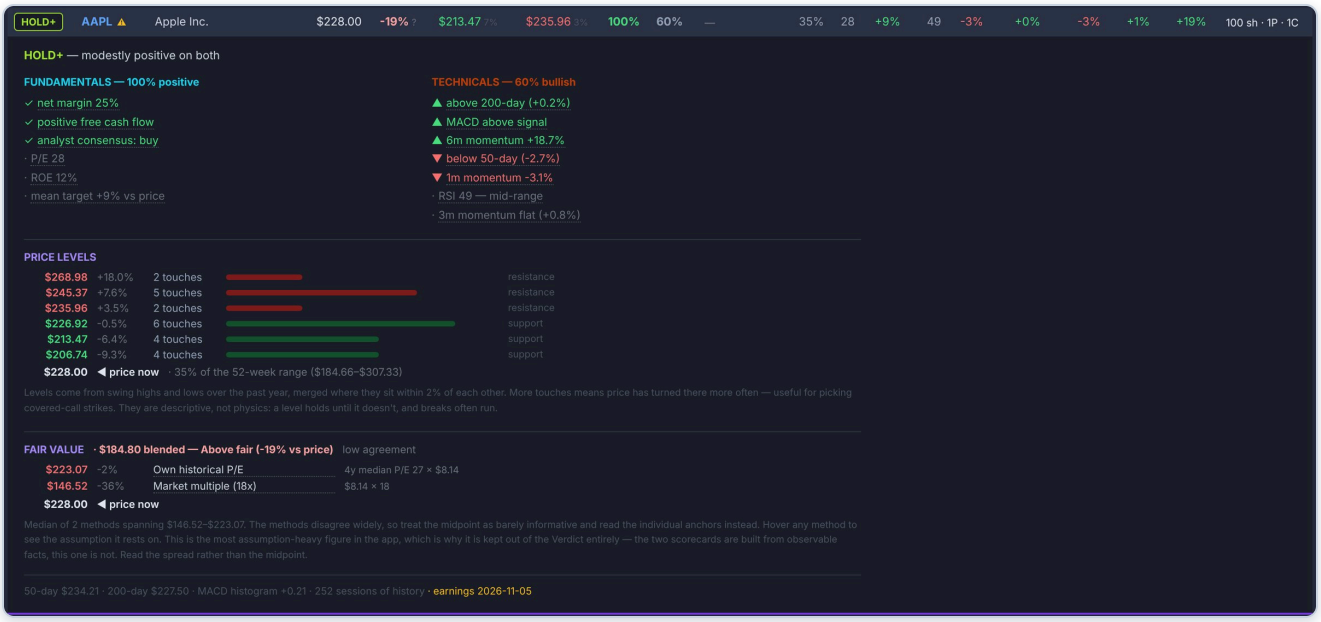
Verdict	Meaning
BUY	The business numbers and the price trend both look good.
HOLD+	Mostly positive.
HOLD	Neutral.
MIXED	The two views disagree. That is information, not a failure.
HOLD-	Mostly negative.
TRIM	Both views look weak.

Column	Meaning
Price, Value	Today's price, and how it compares with the fair-value estimate.
Support, Resist	Nearby price levels where the stock has turned before.
Fund, Tech	Percent of positive signals in the company's numbers (fundamentals) and in the price chart (technicals).
Zone	Stretched high, Overbought, Oversold or Stretched low, when the price has moved far.
52w	Where the price sits in its range over the past year.

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Column	Meaning
P/E, Target	Price to earnings, and the analysts' average target compared with today's price.
RSI	A momentum reading from 0 to 100; above 70 is hot, below 30 is cold.
vs 50d, vs 200d	Price compared with its 50-day and 200-day averages.
1m, 3m, 6m	Price change over 1, 3 and 6 months.
Your position	What you hold: shares (sh), puts (P) and calls (C).

Click any row to open its details: the signals behind the verdict, **Price Levels** with how many times the price touched each one, and **Fair Value** estimates.



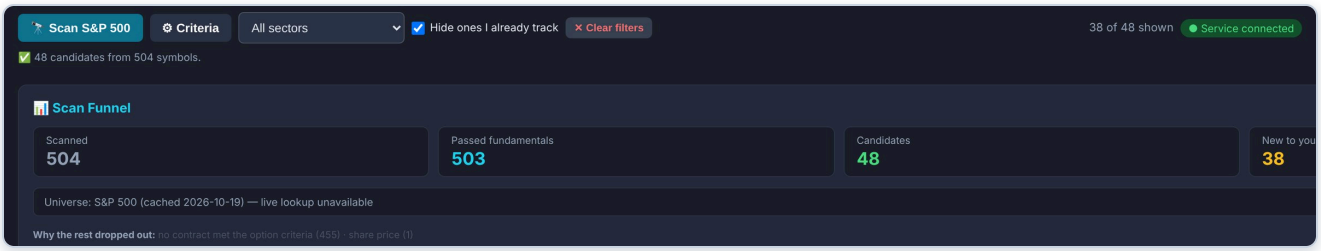
Details for one stock

> **Tip:** run Analysis once before using the 🏅 Scorecard's Concentration section; that is where the sectors come from.

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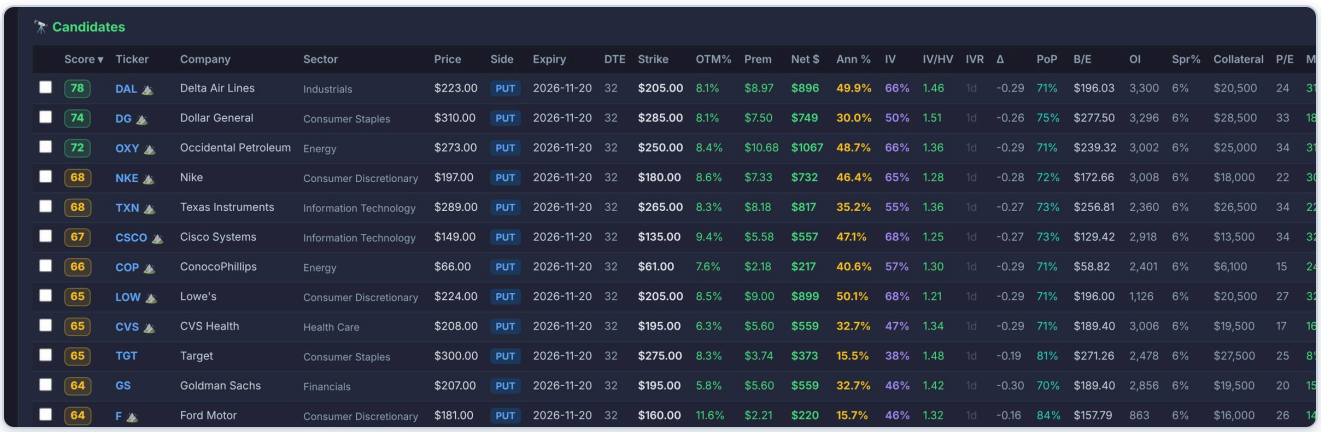
12. The Discover tab

Discover looks through all 500 companies in the S&P 500 to find new names worth adding to your watchlist.



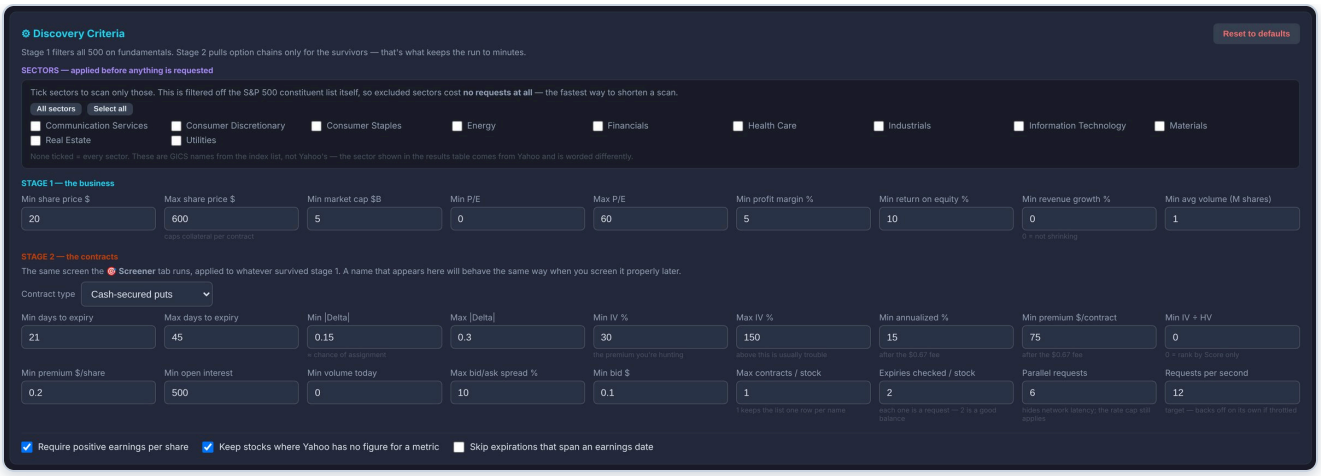
Discover after a scan

1. Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to set the rules (below), or keep the defaults.
2. Click 🔭 **Scan S&P 500**. A full scan takes a few minutes. **✕ Cancel scan** stops it.
3. Read the **Scan Funnel**: how many were scanned, how many passed the business rules, how many had a suitable option, and how many are **New to you**.
4. Use the sector drop-down, **Hide ones I already track** and **✕ Clear filters** to narrow the list.
5. Tick the names you like and click **+ Add N to watchlist**. The Screener will then check them on every run.



Candidates found by the scan

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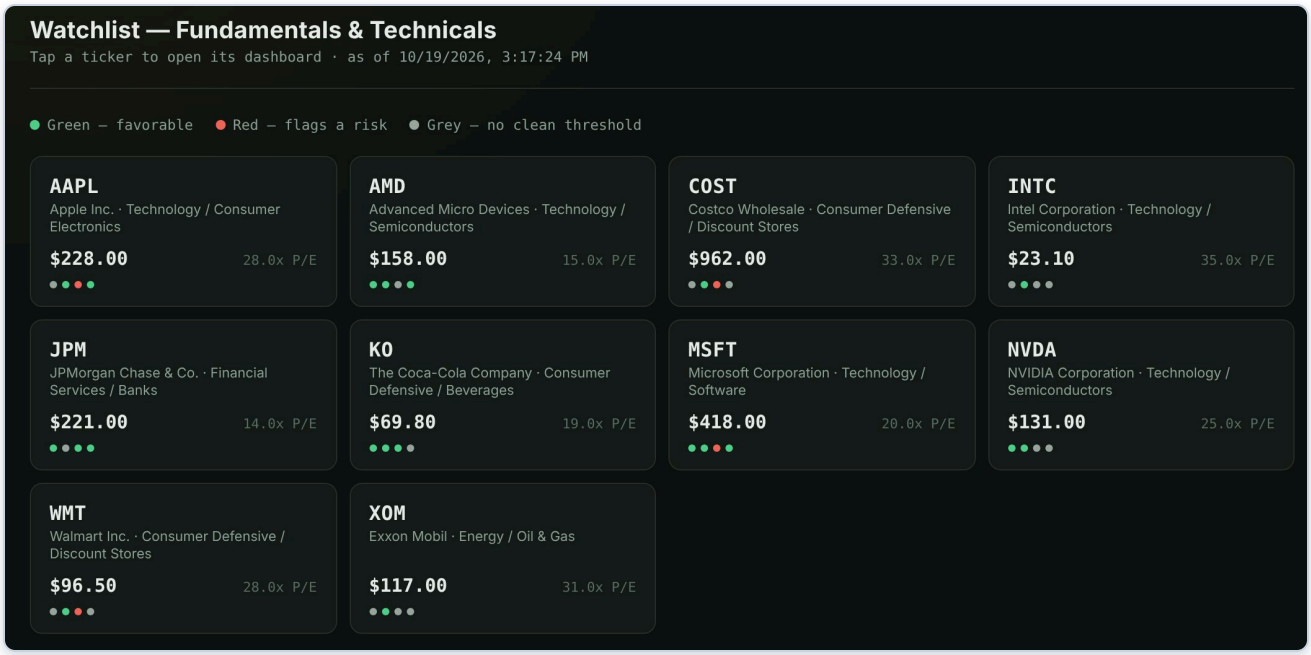


Discovery criteria

The criteria have three parts: **Sectors** (tick some to scan only those; none ticked means all), **Stage 1 — the business** (share price, company size, P/E, profit margin, return on equity, revenue growth, trading volume) and **Stage 2 — the contracts** (the same option rules as the Screener). **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

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13. The Watchlist tab



A card for each stock you hold or trade

The Watchlist shows a card for each stock you hold or have traded, with its price and P/E. The coloured dots summarise the company's health: **green** is favourable, **red** flags a risk, **grey** has no clear answer.

Click a card to open its dashboard. Hover over a box for the reasoning behind its colour. **← All tickers** goes back.

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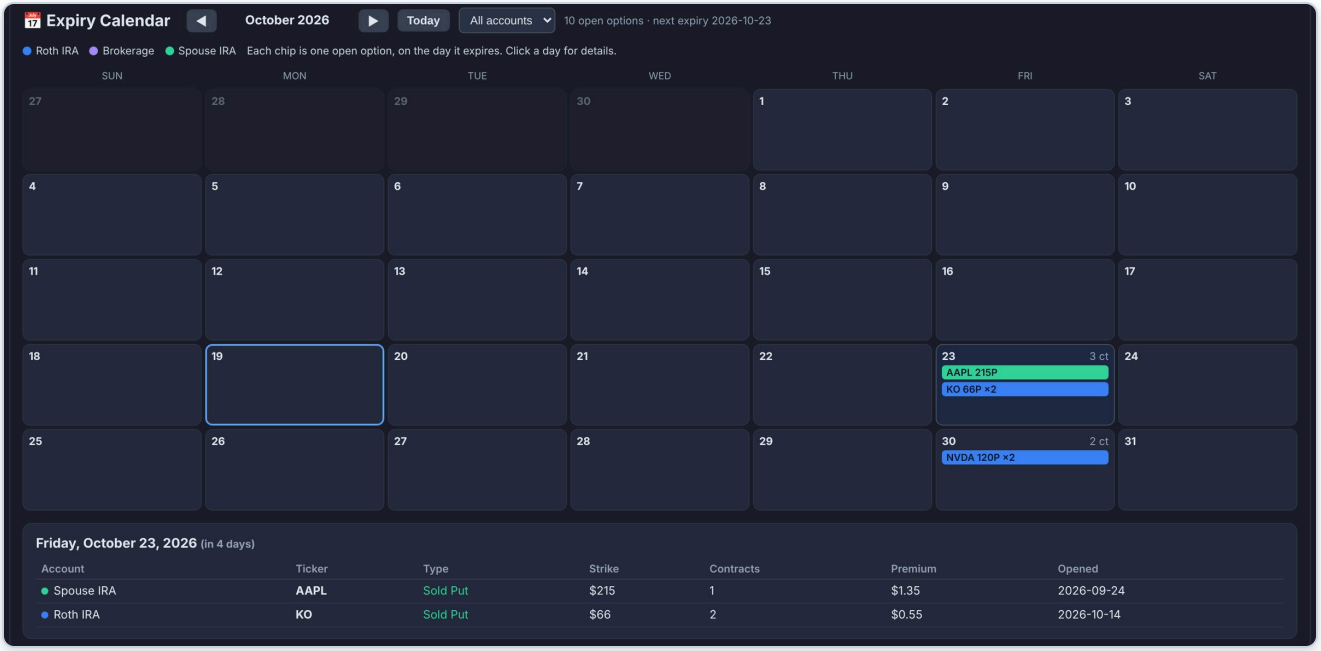


The dashboard for one stock

Box	Meaning
P/E ratio	Price compared with yearly profit per share.
EPS (TTM)	Profit per share over the last 12 months.
Net profit margin	Cents of profit from each dollar of sales.
Debt / Equity	How much the company borrows compared with what it owns.
Revenue, Market cap	Yearly sales and the company's total value.
Beta	How much the stock moves compared with the market. Below 1 is calmer.

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14. The Calendar tab



The expiry calendar, with one day clicked

The Calendar shows each open option on the day it expires, coloured by account.

- ◀ and ▶ change the month; **Today** comes back to this month.
- The drop-down shows **All accounts** or one account.
- Each chip is one open option, for example "KO 66P ×2" (KO, $66 put, 2 contracts). The corner of a day shows the total contracts ("3 ct").
- **Click a day** to list its trades underneath: account, ticker, type, strike, contracts, premium and the day it was opened.

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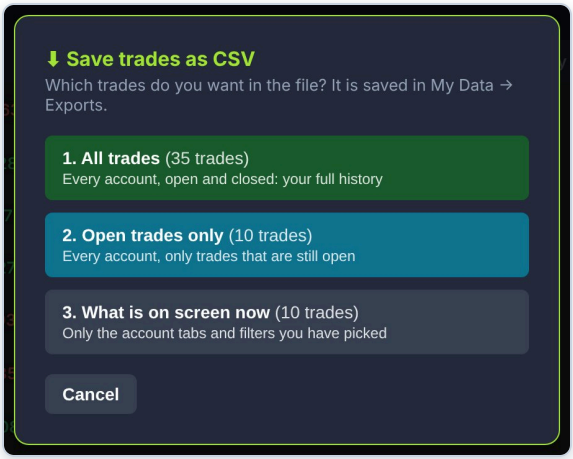


Part 3. Tools, settings and your information

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15. Saving, exporting and bringing in data

⬇️ CSV



⬇️ CSV asks which trades to save

Saves your option trades as a spreadsheet file that opens in Excel. It asks which trades: **1** all trades, open and closed; **2** open trades only; or **3** what is on screen now (after your filters).

📊 Excel

Saves a formatted Excel workbook with a sheet for each account.

Both are saved in **My Data → Exports** inside your app folder, and a message says where.

💾 Save Data and 📂 Load Data

💾 **Save Data** makes a backup of everything: trades, stocks and watchlist. A message shows where it was saved: **My Data → Backups**, in a file named with today's date. The newest 30 are kept.

> **Tip:** to be extra safe, copy the newest backup to a USB stick, email it to yourself, or keep your app folder in OneDrive or Google Drive.

📂 **Load Data** brings back a backup made by 💾 Save Data, or by the browser version (Options Trade Logger). Any account name in the file that you don't have yet is added for you.

⬆️ Import

Brings in past option trades from an Excel file (.xlsx) or a spreadsheet saved as CSV (.csv, .txt or .tsv). Open and closed trades both come in.

1. Open **OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx** in Excel. It holds 8 made-up trades.

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2. Delete the sample rows but keep the first row of headings. Type one row per trade.
3. Save it. A plain Save in Excel is fine. On a Mac in Numbers, use **File → Export To → CSV**.
4. In OptionIQ, click ⬆ **Import**, pick the file and press **OK** to add the trades.
5. Check the trades on 📋 Options. Importing the same file twice gives you every trade twice.

Column	What to type	Example
Account	One of your account names. A new name is listed and you choose whether to create it.	Roth IRA
Date	The day you opened the trade	2026-08-03
Company	The company name (optional)	Apple
Ticker	The stock symbol	AAPL
Strike	The strike price	210
Current Stock	The stock price when you traded (optional)	218.50
Exp Date	The expiry date	2026-08-15
Prem	The premium per share	1.25
Qty	The number of contracts	1
C/P	C for a call, P for a put	P
S/B	S if you sold it, B if you bought it	S
Sells, Total, Net P&L	Leave empty. The app works these out.	
Action	Open, Expired, Assigned, Called Away, Bought to Close, Sold to Close or Rolled	Expired
Close Date	The day the trade ended. Empty for an open trade.	2026-08-15
Close Prem	Dollars for closing all contracts: minus if you paid.	-150

You can also import a file made by ⬇️ CSV. The app finds each column by its heading, so the columns can be in any order.

Import or Load Data: which one?

	📂 Load Data	⬆ Import
File it takes	The .json backup made by 💾 Save Data	A spreadsheet (.xlsx, .csv, .txt, .tsv)
What comes in	Option trades, stocks and watchlist	Option trades only
Pressing OK	Adds only what you don't already have	Adds every row
Pressing Cancel	**Replaces all your data** with the backup	**Replaces all your option trades** with the file

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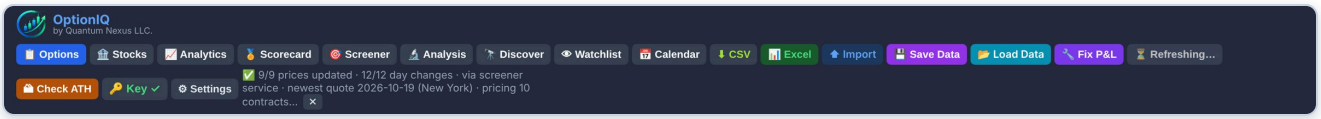
	📂 Load Data	⬆ Import
Use it for	Restoring a backup, or moving to a new computer	Bringing in past trades from a spreadsheet

> **Careful:** in both pop-ups, **Cancel does not mean stop. It means replace everything.** To add trades, press **OK**. Press 💾 Save Data first, so you can go back.

🔧 Fix P&L

Recalculates the Net P&L of every trade. The app asks "Recalculate all Net P&L?" first. Use it if a total looks wrong, for example after editing many rows.

🔄 Prices



The price status line, after 🔄 Prices

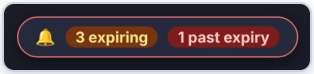
Fetches the latest stock prices (with your Finnhub key) and option prices (through the Screener's helper). While it works, the button reads **Refreshing...**. A status line under the buttons says how many prices were updated; click its ✕ to hide it.

🏔 Check ATH

Looks up the all-time highs of SPY and QQQ, shown next to the account tabs.

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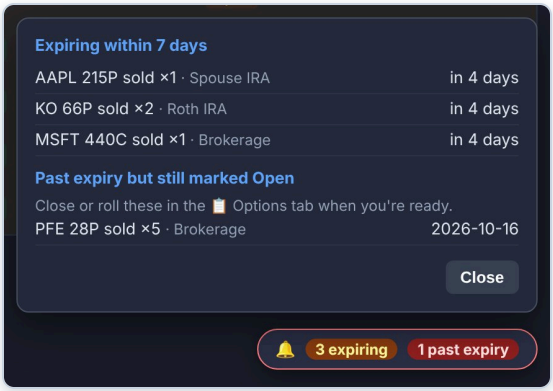
16. Reminders



The 🔔 reminder button in the bottom-right corner

The 🔔 button sits in the bottom-right corner whenever something needs your attention. Click it to see the list.

- **"expiring"**: open options that expire within 7 days (you can change the number of days in ⚙️ Settings).
- **"past expiry"**: options whose expiry date has passed but are still marked Open. The app never changes them on its own; close or roll them yourself.
- **"Backup due"**: your last backup is more than a week old. Click 💾 **Back up now** right there.

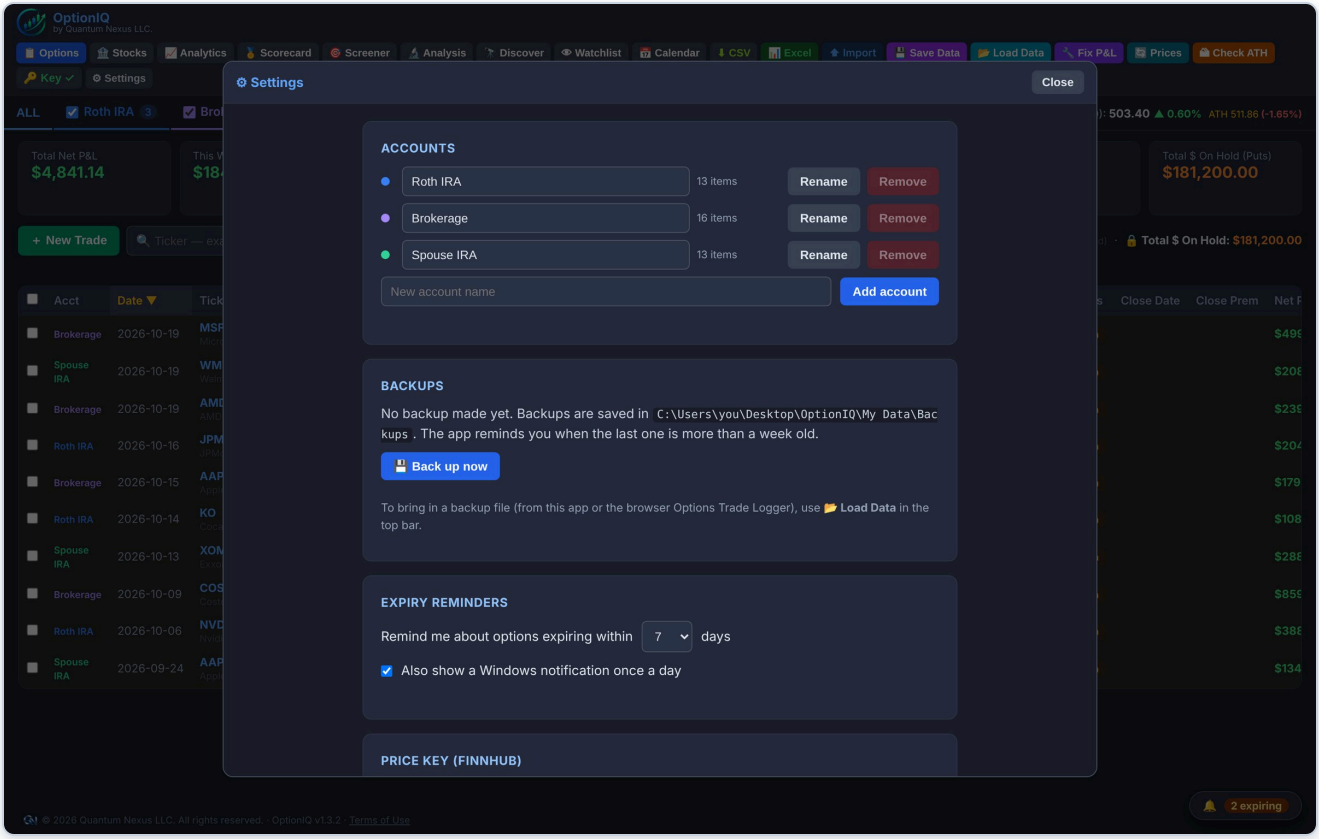


The reminder list, opened

While the app is open, Windows (or your Mac) also shows a small pop-up once a day about options expiring soon.

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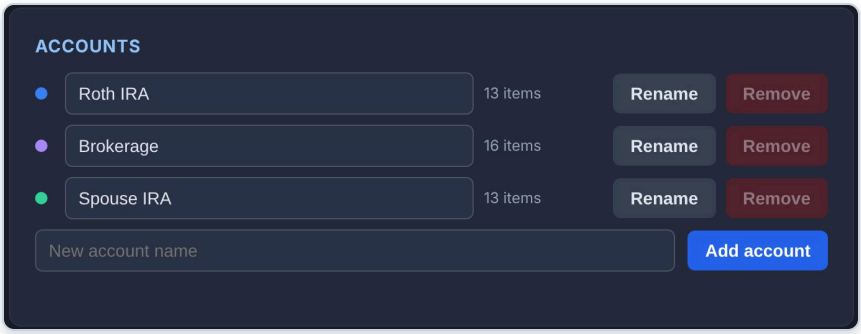
17. Settings



⚙️ Settings opens in a window over the app. Click Close at the top right when done.

⚙️ Settings has six parts.

Accounts

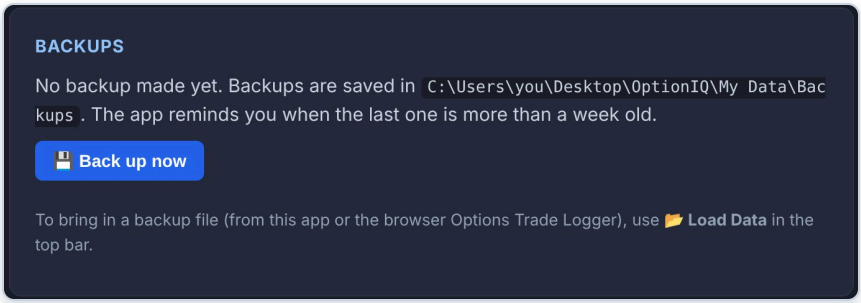


Accounts

- **Rename** an account: type the new name and click Rename. Its trades follow the new name.
- **Remove** works only for an account with no trades or holdings ("0 items").
- Type a name in **New account name** and click **Add account** to add one.

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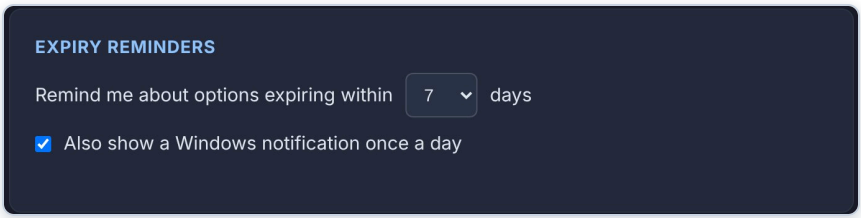
Backups



Backups

Shows when you last backed up and where backups are saved. 💾 **Back up now** makes one. The app reminds you when the last one is more than a week old.

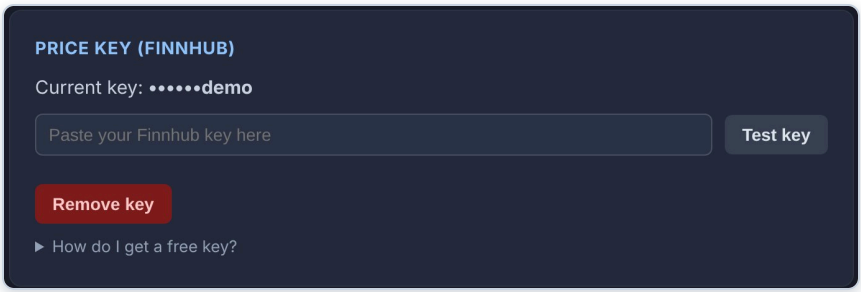
Expiry reminders



Expiry reminders

Choose how many days ahead (1 to 30) to be reminded of expiring options, and whether to also show a Windows (or Mac) notification once a day.

Price key (Finnhub)

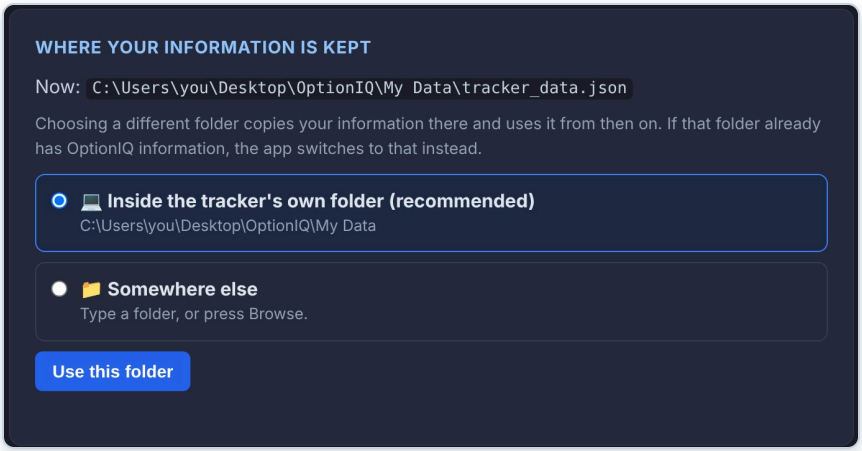


Price key

Shows the end of the key you saved. Paste a new key and click **Test key** to change it, or click **Remove key**. **How do I get a free key?** opens the steps from Chapter 4.

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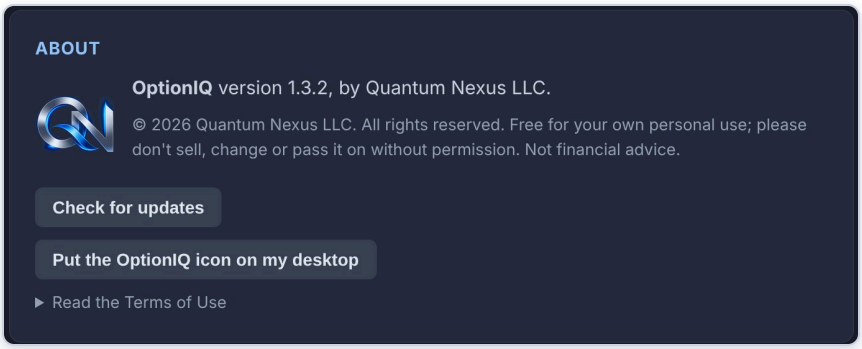
Where your information is kept



Where your information is kept

Shows the file your information is in now. Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)**, or **Somewhere else** (for example a OneDrive or Google Drive folder; type it or click **Browse**), then click **Use this folder**. The app copies your information there and uses it from then on. If that folder already has OptionIQ information, the app switches to that instead.

About

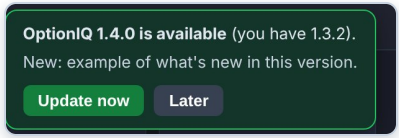


About

Shows your version. **Check for updates** looks for a new version right now. **Put the OptionIQ icon on my desktop** puts the icon back if you deleted it. **Read the Terms of Use** shows the terms.

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18. Updates



A new version is ready

The app looks for a new version when it starts and every 6 hours. When one is ready, a green note appears at the top right with a short list of what's new.

1. Click **Update now**, then **OK**.
2. The app first backs up your information, then downloads the new version. The note shows how far along it is.
3. The app closes and opens again by itself, in the same folder. The footer shows the new version number.

Your trades, stocks, settings and price key stay exactly as they were. **Later** hides the note until the next start.

If the update can't finish (for example the internet drops), the note turns red and nothing is changed. Click **Try again**, or **Download it myself** to get the new zip and extract it over your app folder. On Windows, choose **Replace** when asked about files that already exist. On a Mac, move your **My Data** and **Settings** folders into the new OptionIQ folder.

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Part 4. Training and help

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19. Practice exercises

These exercises use made-up trades, so you can practise without touching your real records. Make a separate practice copy: unzip OptionIQ into a new folder called **OptionIQ Practice**, set it up with any account names, and delete the folder when you are done.

Exercise 1: Bring in sample trades

1. In your practice copy, click ⬆ **Import** and pick **OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx**. Press **OK**. If it lists account names you don't have, press **OK** to create them.
2. On 📋 Options, open ⚙️ **Filters**, set Status to **All**, and see all 8 trades.
3. Click the **Net P&L** heading to sort by profit. Which trade made the most?

Exercise 2: Log a cash-secured put

1. Click **+ New Trade**. Pick an account, type `KO`, strike `66`, an expiry date two Fridays from now, premium `0.55`, contracts `2`, **P – Put**, **S – Sell**.
2. Check the line under the form: Sells about $108.66 and $13,200.00 on hold. Click **Add Trade**.
3. Look at the **Total $ On Hold (Puts)** card: it went up by $13,200.

Exercise 3: Close a trade that expired

1. Find the KO put and click **Close**.
2. Choose **Expired**, leave Close Premium empty, and click **Confirm**. The trade moves to Closed with the full premium as profit.

Exercise 4: A put is assigned, then sell a covered call

1. Log another put, then **Close** it as **Assigned**.
2. Go to 🏦 Stocks: the shares are there with status **Assigned**, at the strike price.
3. Turn on ⚙️ **Filters → Covered Call Opportunity**: the new shares are listed.
4. Go to 🎯 Screener, choose **Covered Calls only** and click 🎯 **Run Screen**. Click **+ Log** on a call above your cost and add it.
5. When the call ends, close it on 📋 Options as **Expired**, or as **Called Away** if your shares were sold.

Exercise 5: Roll an option

1. On 🎯 Screener, click 🔁 **Roll candidates**, set **expire within** to 7 days and click ↻ **Check my positions**.
2. Pick a row with a good **Credit / extra day** and click **Roll ▸**.
3. Check the numbers in the window and click **Confirm Roll**.

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4. Open 🏅 Scorecard: your roll appears under **Rolled vs. left alone**.

Exercise 6: Your weekly routine

1. Start the app and click 🔄 **Prices**.
2. Click the 🔔 button. Close or roll anything past expiry.
3. Check 📅 Calendar for the coming week.
4. Run 🎯 Screener (Weekly) and log any trades you place at your broker.
5. Click 💾 **Save Data**.

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20. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Nothing opens when I double-click Start OptionIQ	Check there is an **app** folder next to it and that unzipping had finished. Try again and wait 10 seconds. If it still won't start, send the file **OptionIQ startup error.txt** from the app folder to whoever shared the app with you.
A blue "Windows protected your PC" box	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
Mac: "Start OptionIQ.command" can't be opened	System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway (Chapter 2).
The Screener says the service isn't connected	Click ↻ **Retry**. If that doesn't help, close the app and start it again.
Screener, Analysis or Discover are empty on first start	Wait for the blue one-time download message to finish.
Prices don't update	Check your internet, then ⚙️ Settings → Price key → **Test key**.
Trades seem to be missing	Check the account tabs (all ticked?) and the ⚙️ **Filters** count. Click ✕ **Clear**.
A total looks wrong	Click 🔧 **Fix P&L**.
An option shows "⏳ expired — still open"	Close it as Expired, Assigned or Called Away.
Concentration shows "Unclassified"	Run 🔬 Analysis once.
Something else	Send the files **tracker.log** and **screener.log** (on a Mac also start.log) from the **Settings** folder to whoever shared the app with you. They hold no trades and no keys.

Where everything is kept. Your app folder holds **My Data** (your trades, backups and exports) and **Settings** (your choices and price key). To move the app or copy it to a new computer, move or copy the whole folder.

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21. Glossary

Word	Meaning
All-time high (ATH)	The highest price an index or stock has ever closed at.
Annualized return	A trade's return stretched or shrunk to a one-year rate, so short and long trades can be compared.
Assigned	The buyer of your option used it: you bought shares (put) or sold them (call).
Break-even	The stock price at which a trade neither makes nor loses money. For a sold put: strike minus premium.
Called away	Your shares were sold because a covered call you sold was assigned.
Cash-secured put	A put you sell while keeping enough cash to buy the shares.
Contract	One option, covering 100 shares.
Cost basis	What you paid per share.
Covered call	A call you sell on shares you own.
Delta (Δ)	Roughly the chance an option ends in the money.
DTE	Days to expiry.
Expiry	The last day of an option.
Implied volatility (IV)	How much movement the option's price expects. Higher IV means higher premium.
In the money (ITM)	A put with the stock below the strike, or a call with the stock above it.
IV Rank (IVR)	Where today's IV sits within its own past year, from 0 to 100.
Net credit	Money received minus money paid, for a roll.
Open interest (OI)	How many contracts of that option exist. Higher is easier to trade.
Out of the money (OTM)	A put with the stock above the strike, or a call with the stock below it.
P/E	Share price divided by yearly profit per share.
Premium	The price of an option, per share.
Probability of profit (PoP)	The estimated chance the trade makes money.
Roll	Buy back an option and sell a new one on the same stock, usually later.
Strike	The price the shares would change hands at.
Unrealised	Profit you would keep if you closed open trades now.
Win rate	The percent of closed trades that made money.

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Words in A to Z order, with the pages where each one is explained. In the PDF, click a page number to jump there.

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